

**Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement
Concerning the International Registration of Marks**

adopted at Madrid on June 27, 1989,
as amended on October 3, 2006,
and on November 12, 2007

**Regulations Under the Protocol Relating
to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the
International Registration of Marks**

(as in force on November 1, 2025)

**Administrative Instructions for the Application of
the Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement
Concerning the International Registration of Marks**

(as in force on February 1, 2023)

Schedule of Fees

(as in force on February 1, 2023)

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Preface

The present publication contains the texts of the Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks (hereinafter referred to as the “Protocol”) (1989), as amended in 2006 and in 2007, the Regulations under the Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks, the Administrative Instructions for the Application of the Protocol and the Schedule of Fees.

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Article 1

Membership in the Madrid Union

The States party to this Protocol (hereinafter referred to as “the Contracting States”), even where they are not party to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks as revised at Stockholm in 1967 and as amended in 1979 (hereinafter referred to as “the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement”), and the organizations referred to in Article 14(1)(b) which are party to this Protocol (hereinafter referred to as “the Contracting Organizations”) shall be members of the same Union of which countries party to the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement are members¹. Any reference in this Protocol to “Contracting Parties” shall be construed as a reference to both Contracting States and Contracting Organizations.

Article 2

Securing Protection through International Registration

- (1) Where an application for the registration of a mark has been filed with the Office of a Contracting Party, or where a mark has been registered in the register of the Office of a Contracting Party, the person in whose name that application (hereinafter referred to as “the basic application”) or that registration (hereinafter referred to as “the basic registration”) stands may, subject to the provisions of this Protocol, secure protection for his mark in the territory of the Contracting Parties, by obtaining the registration of that mark in the register of the International Bureau of the World Intellectual Property Organization (hereinafter referred to as “the international registration,” “the International Register,” “the International Bureau” and “the Organization,” respectively), provided that,
 - (i) where the basic application has been filed with the Office of a Contracting State or where the basic registration has been made by such an Office, the person in whose name that application or registration stands is a national of that Contracting State, or is domiciled, or has a real and effective industrial or commercial establishment, in the said Contracting State,

- (ii) where the basic application has been filed with the Office of a Contracting Organization or where the basic registration has been made by such an Office, the person in whose name that application or registration stands is a national of a State member of that Contracting Organization, or is domiciled, or has a real and effective industrial or commercial establishment, in the territory of the said Contracting Organization.
- (2) The application for international registration (hereinafter referred to as “the international application”) shall be filed with the International Bureau through the intermediary of the Office with which the basic application was filed or by which the basic registration was made (hereinafter referred to as “the Office of origin”), as the case may be.
- (3) Any reference in this Protocol to an “Office” or an “Office of a Contracting Party” shall be construed as a reference to the office that is in charge, on behalf of a Contracting Party, of the registration of marks, and any reference in this Protocol to “marks” shall be construed as a reference to trademarks and service marks.
- (4) For the purposes of this Protocol, “territory of a Contracting Party” means, where the Contracting Party is a State, the territory of that State and, where the Contracting Party is an intergovernmental organization, the territory in which the constituting treaty of that intergovernmental organization applies.

Article 3

International Application

- (1) Every international application under this Protocol shall be presented on the form prescribed by the Regulations. The Office of origin shall certify that the particulars appearing in the international application correspond to the particulars appearing, at the time of the certification, in the basic application or basic registration, as the case may be. Furthermore, the said Office shall indicate,
 - (i) in the case of a basic application, the date and number of that application,

- (ii) in the case of a basic registration, the date and number of that registration as well as the date and number of the application from which the basic registration resulted.

The Office of origin shall also indicate the date of the international application.

- (2) The applicant must indicate the goods and services in respect of which protection of the mark is claimed and also, if possible, the corresponding class or classes according to the classification established by the Nice Agreement Concerning the International Classification of Goods and Services for the Purposes of the Registration of Marks. If the applicant does not give such indication, the International Bureau shall classify the goods and services in the appropriate classes of the said classification. The indication of classes given by the applicant shall be subject to control by the International Bureau, which shall exercise the said control in association with the Office of origin. In the event of disagreement between the said Office and the International Bureau, the opinion of the latter shall prevail.
- (3) If the applicant claims color as a distinctive feature of his mark, he shall be required
 - (i) to state the fact, and to file with his international application a notice specifying the color or the combination of colors claimed;
 - (ii) to append to his international application copies in color of the said mark, which shall be attached to the notifications given by the International Bureau; the number of such copies shall be fixed by the Regulations.

- (4) The International Bureau shall register immediately the marks filed in accordance with Article 2. The international registration shall bear the date on which the international application was received in the Office of origin, provided that the international application has been received by the International Bureau within a period of two months from that date. If the international application has not been received within that period, the international registration shall bear the date on which the said international application was received by the International Bureau. The International Bureau shall notify the international registration without delay to the Offices concerned. Marks registered in the International Register shall be published in a periodical gazette issued by the International Bureau, on the basis of the particulars contained in the international application.
- (5) With a view to the publicity to be given to marks registered in the International Register, each Office shall receive from the International Bureau a number of copies of the said gazette free of charge and a number of copies at a reduced price, under the conditions fixed by the Assembly referred to in Article 10 (hereinafter referred to as “the Assembly”). Such publicity shall be deemed to be sufficient for the purposes of all the Contracting Parties, and no other publicity may be required of the holder of the international registration.

Article 3bis

Territorial Effect

The protection resulting from the international registration shall extend to any Contracting Party only at the request of the person who files the international application or who is the holder of the international registration. However, no such request can be made with respect to the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin.

Article 3ter

Request for “Territorial Extension”

- (1) Any request for extension of the protection resulting from the international registration to any Contracting Party shall be specially mentioned in the international application.

- (2) A request for territorial extension may also be made subsequently to the international registration. Any such request shall be presented on the form prescribed by the Regulations. It shall be immediately recorded by the International Bureau, which shall notify such recordal without delay to the Office or Offices concerned. Such recordal shall be published in the periodical gazette of the International Bureau. Such territorial extension shall be effective from the date on which it has been recorded in the International Register; it shall cease to be valid on the expiry of the international registration to which it relates.

Article 4

Effects of International Registration

- (1) (a) From the date of the registration or recordal effected in accordance with the provisions of Articles 3 and 3~~ter~~, the protection of the mark in each of the Contracting Parties concerned shall be the same as if the mark had been deposited direct with the Office of that Contracting Party. If no refusal has been notified to the International Bureau in accordance with Article 5(1) and (2) or if a refusal notified in accordance with the said Article has been withdrawn subsequently, the protection of the mark in the Contracting Party concerned shall, as from the said date, be the same as if the mark had been registered by the Office of that Contracting Party.
- (b) The indication of classes of goods and services provided for in Article 3 shall not bind the Contracting Parties with regard to the determination of the scope of the protection of the mark.
- (2) Every international registration shall enjoy the right of priority provided for by Article 4 of the Paris Convention for the Protection of Industrial Property, without it being necessary to comply with the formalities prescribed in Section D of that Article.

Article 4bis

Replacement of a National or Regional Registration by an International Registration

- (1) Where a mark that is the subject of a national or regional registration in the Office of a Contracting Party is also the subject of an international registration and both registrations stand in the name of the same person, the international registration is deemed to replace the national or regional registration, without prejudice to any rights acquired by virtue of the latter, provided that
 - (i) the protection resulting from the international registration extends to the said Contracting Party under Article 3ter(1) or (2),
 - (ii) all the goods and services listed in the national or regional registration are also listed in the international registration in respect of the said Contracting Party,
 - (iii) such extension takes effect after the date of the national or regional registration.
- (2) The Office referred to in paragraph (1) shall, upon request, be required to take note in its register of the international registration.

Article 5**Refusal and Invalidation of Effects of International Registration in Respect of Certain Contracting Parties**

- (1) Where the applicable legislation so authorizes, any Office of a Contracting Party which has been notified by the International Bureau of an extension to that Contracting Party, under Article 3~~ter~~(1) or (2), of the protection resulting from the international registration shall have the right to declare in a notification of refusal that protection cannot be granted in the said Contracting Party to the mark which is the subject of such extension. Any such refusal can be based only on the grounds which would apply, under the Paris Convention for the Protection of Industrial Property, in the case of a mark deposited direct with the Office which notifies the refusal. However, protection may not be refused, even partially, by reason only that the applicable legislation would permit registration only in a limited number of classes or for a limited number of goods or services.
- (2)
 - (a) Any Office wishing to exercise such right shall notify its refusal to the International Bureau, together with a statement of all grounds, within the period prescribed by the law applicable to that Office and at the latest, subject to subparagraphs (b) and (c), before the expiry of one year from the date on which the notification of the extension referred to in paragraph (1) has been sent to that Office by the International Bureau.
 - (b) Notwithstanding subparagraph (a), any Contracting Party may declare that, for international registrations made under this Protocol, the time limit of one year referred to in subparagraph (a) is replaced by 18 months.

- (c) Such declaration may also specify that, when a refusal of protection may result from an opposition to the granting of protection, such refusal may be notified by the Office of the said Contracting Party to the International Bureau after the expiry of the 18 month time limit. Such an Office may, with respect to any given international registration, notify a refusal of protection after the expiry of the 18-month time limit, but only if
 - (i) it has, before the expiry of the 18-month time limit, informed the International Bureau of the possibility that oppositions may be filed after the expiry of the 18-month time limit, and
 - (ii) the notification of the refusal based on an opposition is made within a time limit of one month from the expiry of the opposition period and, in any case, not later than seven months from the date on which the opposition period begins.
- (d) Any declaration under subparagraphs (b) or (c) may be made in the instruments referred to in Article 14(2), and the effective date of the declaration shall be the same as the date of entry into force of this Protocol with respect to the State or intergovernmental organization having made the declaration. Any such declaration may also be made later, in which case the declaration shall have effect three months after its receipt by the Director General of the Organization (hereinafter referred to as “the Director General”), or at any later date indicated in the declaration, in respect of any international registration whose date is the same as or is later than the effective date of the declaration.
- (e) Upon the expiry of a period of ten years from the entry into force of this Protocol, the Assembly shall examine the operation of the system established by subparagraphs (a) to (d). Thereafter, the provisions of the said subparagraphs may be modified by a unanimous decision of the Assembly².

- (3) The International Bureau shall, without delay, transmit one of the copies of the notification of refusal to the holder of the international registration. The said holder shall have the same remedies as if the mark had been deposited by him direct with the Office which has notified its refusal. Where the International Bureau has received information under paragraph (2)(c)(i), it shall, without delay, transmit the said information to the holder of the international registration.
- (4) The grounds for refusing a mark shall be communicated by the International Bureau to any interested party who may so request.
- (5) Any Office which has not notified, with respect to a given international registration, any provisional or final refusal to the International Bureau in accordance with paragraphs (1) and (2) shall, with respect to that international registration, lose the benefit of the right provided for in paragraph (1).
- (6) Invalidity, by the competent authorities of a Contracting Party, of the effects, in the territory of that Contracting Party, of an international registration may not be pronounced without the holder of such international registration having, in good time, been afforded the opportunity of defending his rights. Invalidity shall be notified to the International Bureau.

Article 5bis

Documentary Evidence of Legitimacy of Use of Certain Elements of the Mark

Documentary evidence of the legitimacy of the use of certain elements incorporated in a mark, such as armorial bearings, escutcheons, portraits, honorary distinctions, titles, trade names, names of persons other than the name of the applicant, or other like inscriptions, which might be required by the Offices of the Contracting Parties shall be exempt from any legalization as well as from any certification other than that of the Office of origin.

Article 5^{ter}

Copies of Entries in International Register; Searches for Anticipations; Extracts from International Register

- (1) The International Bureau shall issue to any person applying therefor, upon the payment of a fee fixed by the Regulations, a copy of the entries in the International Register concerning a specific mark.
- (2) The International Bureau may also, upon payment, undertake searches for anticipations among marks that are the subject of international registrations.
- (3) Extracts from the International Register requested with a view to their production in one of the Contracting Parties shall be exempt from any legalization.

Article 6

Period of Validity of International Registration; Dependence and Independence of International Registration

- (1) Registration of a mark at the International Bureau is effected for ten years, with the possibility of renewal under the conditions specified in Article 7.
- (2) Upon expiry of a period of five years from the date of the international registration, such registration shall become independent of the basic application or the registration resulting therefrom, or of the basic registration, as the case may be, subject to the following provisions.

- (3) The protection resulting from the international registration, whether or not it has been the subject of a transfer, may no longer be invoked if, before the expiry of five years from the date of the international registration, the basic application or the registration resulting therefrom, or the basic registration, as the case may be, has been withdrawn, has lapsed, has been renounced or has been the subject of a final decision of rejection, revocation, cancellation or invalidation, in respect of all or some of the goods and services listed in the international registration. The same applies if
- (i) an appeal against a decision refusing the effects of the basic application,
 - (ii) an action requesting the withdrawal of the basic application or the revocation, cancellation or invalidation of the registration resulting from the basic application or of the basic registration, or
 - (iii) an opposition to the basic application

results, after the expiry of the five-year period, in a final decision of rejection, revocation, cancellation or invalidation, or ordering the withdrawal, of the basic application, or the registration resulting therefrom, or the basic registration, as the case may be, provided that such appeal, action or opposition had begun before the expiry of the said period. The same also applies if the basic application is withdrawn, or the registration resulting from the basic application or the basic registration is renounced, after the expiry of the five-year period, provided that, at the time of the withdrawal or renunciation, the said application or registration was the subject of a proceeding referred to in item (i), (ii) or (iii) and that such proceeding had begun before the expiry of the said period.

- (4) The Office of origin shall, as prescribed in the Regulations, notify the International Bureau of the facts and decisions relevant under paragraph (3), and the International Bureau shall, as prescribed in the Regulations, notify the interested parties and effect any publication accordingly. The Office of origin shall, where applicable, request the International Bureau to cancel, to the extent applicable, the international registration, and the International Bureau shall proceed accordingly.

Article 7

Renewal of International Registration

- (1) Any international registration may be renewed for a period of ten years from the expiry of the preceding period, by the mere payment of the basic fee and, subject to Article 8(7), of the supplementary and complementary fees provided for in Article 8(2).
- (2) Renewal may not bring about any change in the international registration in its latest form.
- (3) Six months before the expiry of the term of protection, the International Bureau shall, by sending an unofficial notice, remind the holder of the international registration and his representative, if any, of the exact date of expiry.
- (4) Subject to the payment of a surcharge fixed by the Regulations, a period of grace of six months shall be allowed for renewal of the international registration.

Article 8

Fees for International Application and Registration

- (1) The Office of origin may fix, at its own discretion, and collect, for its own benefit, a fee which it may require from the applicant for international registration or from the holder of the international registration in connection with the filing of the international application or the renewal of the international registration.

- (2) Registration of a mark at the International Bureau shall be subject to the advance payment of an international fee which shall, subject to the provisions of paragraph (7)(a), include,
- (i) a basic fee;
 - (ii) a supplementary fee for each class of the International Classification, beyond three, into which the goods or services to which the mark is applied will fall;
 - (iii) a complementary fee for any request for extension of protection under Article 3*ter*.
- (3) However, the supplementary fee specified in paragraph (2)(ii) may, without prejudice to the date of the international registration, be paid within the period fixed by the Regulations if the number of classes of goods or services has been fixed or disputed by the International Bureau. If, upon expiry of the said period, the supplementary fee has not been paid or the list of goods or services has not been reduced to the required extent by the applicant, the international application shall be deemed to have been abandoned.
- (4) The annual product of the various receipts from international registration, with the exception of the receipts derived from the fees mentioned in paragraph (2)(ii) and (iii), shall be divided equally among the Contracting Parties by the International Bureau, after deduction of the expenses and charges necessitated by the implementation of this Protocol.
- (5) The amounts derived from the supplementary fees provided for in paragraph (2)(ii) shall be divided, at the expiry of each year, among the interested Contracting Parties in proportion to the number of marks for which protection has been applied for in each of them during that year, this number being multiplied, in the case of Contracting Parties which make an examination, by a coefficient which shall be determined by the Regulations.
- (6) The amounts derived from the complementary fees provided for in paragraph (2)(iii) shall be divided according to the same rules as those provided for in paragraph (5).

- (7) (a) Any Contracting Party may declare that, in connection with each international registration in which it is mentioned under Article 3ter, and in connection with the renewal of any such international registration, it wants to receive, instead of a share in the revenue produced by the supplementary and complementary fees, a fee (hereinafter referred to as “the individual fee”) whose amount shall be indicated in the declaration, and can be changed in further declarations, but may not be higher than the equivalent of the amount which the said Contracting Party’s Office would be entitled to receive from an applicant for a ten-year registration, or from the holder of a registration for a ten-year renewal of that registration, of the mark in the register of the said Office, the said amount being diminished by the savings resulting from the international procedure. Where such an individual fee is payable,
- (i) no supplementary fees referred to in paragraph (2)(ii) shall be payable if only Contracting Parties which have made a declaration under this subparagraph are mentioned under Article 3ter, and
 - (ii) no complementary fee referred to in paragraph (2)(iii) shall be payable in respect of any Contracting Party which has made a declaration under this subparagraph.
- (b) Any declaration under subparagraph (a) may be made in the instruments referred to in Article 14(2), and the effective date of the declaration shall be the same as the date of entry into force of this Protocol with respect to the State or intergovernmental organization having made the declaration. Any such declaration may also be made later, in which case the declaration shall have effect three months after its receipt by the Director General, or at any later date indicated in the declaration, in respect of any international registration whose date is the same as or is later than the effective date of the declaration.

Article 9**Recordal of Change in the Ownership of an International Registration**

At the request of the person in whose name the international registration stands, or at the request of an interested Office made *ex officio* or at the request of an interested person, the International Bureau shall record in the International Register any change in the ownership of that registration, in respect of all or some of the Contracting Parties in whose territories the said registration has effect and in respect of all or some of the goods and services listed in the registration, provided that the new holder is a person who, under Article 2(1), is entitled to file international applications.

Article 9bis**Recordal of Certain Matters Concerning an International Registration**

The International Bureau shall record in the International Register

- (i) any change in the name or address of the holder of the international registration,
- (ii) the appointment of a representative of the holder of the international registration and any other relevant fact concerning such representative,
- (iii) any limitation, in respect of all or some of the Contracting Parties, of the goods and services listed in the international registration,
- (iv) any renunciation, cancellation or invalidation of the international registration in respect of all or some of the Contracting Parties,
- (v) any other relevant fact, identified in the Regulations, concerning the rights in a mark that is the subject of an international registration.

Article 9^{ter}

Fees for Certain Recordals

Any recordal under Article 9 or under Article 9^{bis} may be subject to the payment of a fee.

Article 9^{quater}

Common Office of Several Contracting States

- (1) If several Contracting States agree to effect the unification of their domestic legislations on marks, they may notify the Director General
 - (i) that a common Office shall be substituted for the national Office of each of them, and
 - (ii) that the whole of their respective territories shall be deemed to be a single State for the purposes of the application of all or part of the provisions preceding this Article as well as the provisions of Articles 9^{quinquies} and 9^{sexies}.
- (2) Such notification shall not take effect until three months after the date of the communication thereof by the Director General to the other Contracting Parties.

Article 9quinquies

Transformation of an International Registration into National or Regional Applications

Where, in the event that the international registration is cancelled at the request of the Office of origin under Article 6(4), in respect of all or some of the goods and services listed in the said registration, the person who was the holder of the international registration files an application for the registration of the same mark with the Office of any of the Contracting Parties in the territory of which the international registration had effect, that application shall be treated as if it had been filed on the date of the international registration according to Article 3(4) or on the date of recordal of the territorial extension according to Article 3ter(2) and, if the international registration enjoyed priority, shall enjoy the same priority, provided that

- (i) such application is filed within three months from the date on which the international registration was cancelled,
- (ii) the goods and services listed in the application are in fact covered by the list of goods and services contained in the international registration in respect of the Contracting Party concerned, and
- (iii) such application complies with all the requirements of the applicable law, including the requirements concerning fees.

Article 9sexies

Relations Between States Party to both this Protocol and the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement

- (1) (a) This Protocol alone shall be applicable as regards the mutual relations of States party to both this Protocol and the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement.

- (b) Notwithstanding subparagraph (a), a declaration made under Article 5(2)(b), Article 5(2)(c) or Article 8(7) of this Protocol, by a State party to both this Protocol and the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement, shall have no effect in the relations with another State party to both this Protocol and the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement.
- (2) The Assembly shall, after the expiry of a period of three years from September 1, 2008, review the application of paragraph (1)(b) and may, at any time thereafter, either repeal it or restrict its scope, by a three-fourths majority. In the vote of the Assembly, only those States which are party to both the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement and this Protocol shall have the right to participate.

Article 10

Assembly

- (1)
 - (a) The Contracting Parties shall be members of the same Assembly as the countries party to the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement.
 - (b) Each Contracting Party shall be represented in that Assembly by one delegate, who may be assisted by alternate delegates, advisors, and experts.
 - (c) The expenses of each delegation shall be borne by the Contracting Party which has appointed it, except for the travel expenses and the subsistence allowance of one delegate for each Contracting Party, which shall be paid from the funds of the Union.

- (2) The Assembly shall, in addition to the functions which it has under the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement³, also
- (i) deal with all matters concerning the implementation of this Protocol;
 - (ii) give directions to the International Bureau concerning the preparation for conferences of revision of this Protocol, due account being taken of any comments made by those countries of the Union which are not party to this Protocol;
 - (iii) adopt and modify the provisions of the Regulations concerning the implementation of this Protocol;
 - (iv) perform such other functions as are appropriate under this Protocol.
- (3) (a) Each Contracting Party shall have one vote in the Assembly. On matters concerning only countries that are party to the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement, Contracting Parties that are not party to the said Agreement shall not have the right to vote, whereas, on matters concerning only Contracting Parties, only the latter shall have the right to vote.
- (b) One-half of the members of the Assembly which have the right to vote on a given matter shall constitute the quorum for the purposes of the vote on that matter.

- (c) Notwithstanding the provisions of subparagraph (b), if, in any session, the number of the members of the Assembly having the right to vote on a given matter which are represented is less than one-half but equal to or more than one-third of the members of the Assembly having the right to vote on that matter, the Assembly may make decisions but, with the exception of decisions concerning its own procedure, all such decisions shall take effect only if the conditions set forth hereinafter are fulfilled. The International Bureau shall communicate the said decisions to the members of the Assembly having the right to vote on the said matter which were not represented and shall invite them to express in writing their vote or abstention within a period of three months from the date of the communication. If, at the expiry of this period, the number of such members having thus expressed their vote or abstention attains the number of the members which was lacking for attaining the quorum in the session itself, such decisions shall take effect provided that at the same time the required majority still obtains.
- (d) Subject to the provisions of Articles 5(2)(e), 9*sexies*(2), 12 and 13(2), the decisions of the Assembly shall require two-thirds of the votes cast.
- (e) Abstentions shall not be considered as votes.
- (f) A delegate may represent, and vote in the name of, one member of the Assembly only.

- (4) In addition to meeting in ordinary sessions and extraordinary sessions as provided for by the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement, the Assembly shall meet in extraordinary session upon convocation by the Director General, at the request of one-fourth of the members of the Assembly having the right to vote on the matters proposed to be included in the agenda of the session. The agenda of such an extraordinary session shall be prepared by the Director General.

Article 11

International Bureau

- (1) International registration and related duties, as well as all other administrative tasks, under or concerning this Protocol, shall be performed by the International Bureau.
- (2)
 - (a) The International Bureau shall, in accordance with the directions of the Assembly, make the preparations for the conferences of revision of this Protocol.
 - (b) The International Bureau may consult with intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations concerning preparations for such conferences of revision
 - (c) The Director General and persons designated by him shall take part, without the right to vote, in the discussions at such conferences of revision.
- (3) The International Bureau shall carry out any other tasks assigned to it in relation to this Protocol.

Article 12

Finances

As far as Contracting Parties are concerned, the finances of the Union shall be governed by the same provisions as those contained in Article 12 of the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement⁴, provided that any reference to Article 8 of the said Agreement shall be deemed to be a reference to Article 8 of this Protocol. Furthermore, for the purposes of Article 12(6)(b) of the said Agreement, Contracting Organizations shall, subject to a unanimous decision to the contrary by the Assembly, be considered to belong to contribution class I (one) under the Paris Convention for the Protection of Industrial Property.

Article 13

Amendment of Certain Articles of the Protocol

- (1) Proposals for the amendment of Articles 10, 11, 12, and the present Article, may be initiated by any Contracting Party, or by the Director General. Such proposals shall be communicated by the Director General to the Contracting Parties at least six months in advance of their consideration by the Assembly.
- (2) Amendments to the Articles referred to in paragraph (1) shall be adopted by the Assembly. Adoption shall require three-fourths of the votes cast, provided that any amendment to Article 10, and to the present paragraph, shall require four-fifths of the votes cast.
- (3) Any amendment to the Articles referred to in paragraph (1) shall enter into force one month after written notifications of acceptance, effected in accordance with their respective constitutional processes, have been received by the Director General from three-fourths of those States and intergovernmental organizations which, at the time the amendment was adopted, were members of the Assembly and had the right to vote on the amendment. Any amendment to the said Articles thus accepted shall bind all the States and intergovernmental organizations which are Contracting Parties at the time the amendment enters into force, or which become Contracting Parties at a subsequent date.

Article 14**Becoming Party to the Protocol; Entry into Force**

- (1)
 - (a) Any State that is a party to the Paris Convention for the Protection of Industrial Property may become party to this Protocol.
 - (b) Furthermore, any intergovernmental organization may also become party to this Protocol where the following conditions are fulfilled:
 - (i) at least one of the member States of that organization is a party to the Paris Convention for the Protection of Industrial Property;
 - (ii) that organization has a regional Office for the purposes of registering marks with effect in the territory of the organization, provided that such Office is not the subject of a notification under Article 9*quater*.
- (2) Any State or organization referred to in paragraph (1) may sign this Protocol. Any such State or organization may, if it has signed this Protocol, deposit an instrument of ratification, acceptance or approval of this Protocol or, if it has not signed this Protocol, deposit an instrument of accession to this Protocol.
- (3) The instruments referred to in paragraph (2) shall be deposited with the Director General.
- (4)
 - (a) This Protocol shall enter into force three months after four instruments of ratification, acceptance, approval or accession have been deposited, provided that at least one of those instruments has been deposited by a country party to the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement and at least one other of those instruments has been deposited by a State not party to the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement or by any of the organizations referred to in paragraph (1)(b).

- (b) With respect to any other State or organization referred to in paragraph (1), this Protocol shall enter into force three months after the date on which its ratification, acceptance, approval or accession has been notified by the Director General.
- (5) Any State or organization referred to in paragraph (1) may, when depositing its instrument of ratification, acceptance or approval of, or accession to, this Protocol, declare that the protection resulting from any international registration effected under this Protocol before the date of entry into force of this Protocol with respect to it cannot be extended to it.

Article 15

Denunciation

- (1) This Protocol shall remain in force without limitation as to time.
- (2) Any Contracting Party may denounce this Protocol by notification addressed to the Director General.
- (3) Denunciation shall take effect one year after the day on which the Director General has received the notification.
- (4) The right of denunciation provided for by this Article shall not be exercised by any Contracting Party before the expiry of five years from the date upon which this Protocol entered into force with respect to that Contracting Party.

- (5) (a) Where a mark is the subject of an international registration having effect in the denouncing State or intergovernmental organization at the date on which the denunciation becomes effective, the holder of such registration may file an application for the registration of the same mark with the Office of the denouncing State or intergovernmental organization, which shall be treated as if it had been filed on the date of the international registration according to Article 3(4) or on the date of recordal of the territorial extension according to Article 3ter(2) and, if the international registration enjoyed priority, enjoy the same priority, provided that
- (i) such application is filed within two years from the date on which the denunciation became effective,
 - (ii) the goods and services listed in the application are in fact covered by the list of goods and services contained in the international registration in respect of the denouncing State or intergovernmental organization, and
 - (iii) such application complies with all the requirements of the applicable law, including the requirements concerning fees.
- (b) The provisions of subparagraph (a) shall also apply in respect of any mark that is the subject of an international registration having effect in Contracting Parties other than the denouncing State or intergovernmental organization at the date on which denunciation becomes effective and whose holder, because of the denunciation, is no longer entitled to file international applications under Article 2(1).

Article 16

Signature; Languages; Depositary Functions

- (1) (a) This Protocol shall be signed in a single copy in the English, French and Spanish languages, and shall be deposited with the Director General when it ceases to be open for signature at Madrid. The texts in the three languages shall be equally authentic.
- (b) Official texts of this Protocol shall be established by the Director General, after consultation with the interested governments and organizations, in the Arabic, Chinese, German, Italian, Japanese, Portuguese and Russian languages, and in such other languages as the Assembly may designate.
- (2) This Protocol shall remain open for signature at Madrid until December 31, 1989.
- (3) The Director General shall transmit two copies, certified by the Government of Spain, of the signed texts of this Protocol to all States and intergovernmental organizations that may become party to this Protocol.
- (4) The Director General shall register this Protocol with the Secretariat of the United Nations.
- (5) The Director General shall notify all States and international organizations that may become or are party to this Protocol of signatures, deposits of instruments of ratification, acceptance, approval or accession, the entry into force of this Protocol and any amendment thereto, any notification of denunciation and any declaration provided for in this Protocol.

¹ Article 1 of the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement reads as follows:

"Article 1

**[Establishment of a Special Union. Filing of Marks at International Bureau.
Definition of Country of Origin]**

- (1) The countries to which this Agreement applies constitute a Special Union for the International registration of marks.

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- (2) Nationals of any of the contracting countries may, in all the other countries party to this Agreement, secure protection for their marks applicable to goods or services, registered in the country of origin, by filing the said marks at the International Bureau of Intellectual Property (hereinafter designated as "the International Bureau") referred to in the Convention establishing the World Intellectual Property Organization (hereinafter designated as "the Organization"), through the intermediary of the Office of the said country of origin.
 - (3) Shall be considered the country of origin the country of the Special Union where the applicant has a real and effective industrial or commercial establishment; if he has no such establishment in a country of the Special Union, the country of the Special Union where he has his domicile; if he has no domicile within the Special Union but is a national of a country of the Special Union, the country of which he is a national."

² Interpretative statement adopted by the Assembly of the Madrid Union:
 "Article 5(2)(e) of the Protocol is understood as allowing the Assembly to keep under review the operation of the system established by subparagraphs (a) to (d), it being also understood that any modification of those provisions shall require a unanimous decision of the Assembly."

³ Article 10 of the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement reads as follows:

"Article 10

[Assembly of the Special Union]

- (1) (a) The Special Union shall have an Assembly consisting of those countries which have ratified or acceded to this Act.
- (b) The Government of each country shall be represented by one delegate, who may be assisted by alternate delegates, advisors, and experts.
- (c) The expenses of each delegation shall be borne by the Government which has appointed it, except for the travel expenses and the subsistence allowance of one delegate for each member country, which shall be paid from the funds of the Special Union.
- (2) (a) The Assembly shall:
 - (i) deal with all matters concerning the maintenance and development of the Special Union and the implementation of this Agreement;
 - (ii) give directions to the International Bureau concerning the preparation for conferences of revision, due account being taken of any comments made by those countries of the Special Union which have not ratified or acceded to this Act;

- (iii) modify the Regulations, including the fixation of the amounts of the fees referred to in Article 8(2) and other fees relating to international registration;
 - (iv) review and approve the reports and activities of the Director General concerning the Special Union, and give him all necessary instructions concerning matters within the competence of the Special Union;
 - (v) determine the program and adopt the biennial budget of the Special Union, and approve its final accounts;
 - (vi) adopt the financial regulations of the Special Union;
 - (vii) establish such committees of experts and working groups as it may deem necessary to achieve the objectives of the Special Union;
 - (viii) determine which countries not members of the Special Union and which intergovernmental and international non-governmental organizations shall be admitted to its meetings as observers;
 - (ix) adopt amendments to Articles 10 to 13;
 - (x) take any other appropriate action designed to further the objectives of the Special Union;
 - (xi) perform such other functions as are appropriate under this Agreement.
 - (b) With respect to matters which are of interest also to other Unions administered by the Organization, the Assembly shall make its decisions after having heard the advice of the Coordination Committee of the Organization.
- (3)
- (a) Each country member of the Assembly shall have one vote.
 - (b) One-half of the countries members of the Assembly shall constitute a quorum.

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- (c) Notwithstanding the provisions of subparagraph (b), if, in any session, the number of countries represented is less than one-half but equal to or more than one-third of the countries members of the Assembly, the Assembly may make decisions but, with the exception of decisions concerning its own procedure, all such decisions shall take effect only if the conditions set forth hereinafter are fulfilled. The International Bureau shall communicate the said decisions to the countries members of the Assembly which were not represented and shall invite them to express in writing their vote or abstention within a period of three months from the date of the communication. If, at the expiration of this period, the number of countries having thus expressed their vote or abstention attains the number of countries which was lacking for attaining the quorum in the session itself, such decisions shall take effect provided that at the same time the required majority still obtains.
 - (d) Subject to the provisions of Article 13(2), the decisions of the Assembly shall require two-thirds of the votes cast.
 - (e) Abstentions shall not be considered as votes.
 - (f) A delegate may represent, and vote in the name of, one country only.
 - (g) Countries of the Special Union not members of the Assembly shall be admitted to the meetings of the latter as observers.
 - (4) (a) The Assembly shall meet once in every second calendar year in ordinary session upon convocation by the Director General and, in the absence of exceptional circumstances, during the same period and at the same place as the General Assembly of the Organization.
 - (b) The Assembly shall meet in extraordinary session upon convocation by the Director General, at the request of one-fourth of the countries members of the Assembly.
 - (c) The agenda of each session shall be prepared by the Director General.
 - (5) The Assembly shall adopt its own rules of procedure."

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Article 12 of the Madrid (Stockholm) Agreement reads as follows :

"Article 12
[Finances]

- (1) (a) The Special Union shall have a budget.

- (b) The budget of the Special Union shall include the income and expenses proper to the Special Union, its contribution to the budget of expenses common to the Unions, and, where applicable, the sum made available to the budget of the Conference of the Organization.
 - (c) Expenses not attributable exclusively to the Special Union but also to one or more other Unions administered by the Organization shall be considered as expenses common to the Unions. The share of the Special Union in such common expenses shall be in proportion to the interest the Special Union has in them.
- (2) The budget of the Special Union shall be established with due regard to the requirements of coordination with the budgets of the other Unions administered by the Organization.
- (3) The budget of the Special Union shall be financed from the following sources:
 - (i) international registration fees and other fees and charges due for other services rendered by the International Bureau in relation to the Special Union;
 - (ii) sale of, or royalties on, the publications of the International Bureau concerning the Special Union;
 - (iii) gifts, bequests, and subventions;
 - (iv) rents, interests, and other miscellaneous income.
- (4)
 - (a) The amounts of the fees referred to in Article 8(2) and other fees relating to international registration shall be fixed by the Assembly on the proposal of the Director General.
 - (b) The amounts of such fees shall be so fixed that the revenues of the Special Union from fees, other than the supplementary and complementary fees referred to in Article 8(2)(b) and (c), and other sources shall be at least sufficient to cover the expenses of the International Bureau concerning the Special Union.
 - (c) If the budget is not adopted before the beginning of a new financial period, it shall be at the same level as the budget of the previous year, as provided in the financial regulations.
- (5) Subject to the provisions of paragraph (4)(a), the amount of fees and charges due for other services rendered by the International Bureau in relation to the Special Union shall be established, and shall be reported to the Assembly, by the Director General.

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- (6) (a) The Special Union shall have a working capital fund which shall be constituted by a single payment made by each country of the Special Union. If the fund becomes insufficient, the Assembly shall decide to increase it.
- (b) The amount of the initial payment of each country to the said fund or of its participation in the increase thereof shall be a proportion of the contribution of that country as a member of the Paris Union for the Protection of Industrial Property to the budget of the said Union for the year in which the fund is established or the decision to increase it is made.
- (c) The proportion and the terms of payment shall be fixed by the Assembly on the proposal of the Director General and after it has heard the advice of the Coordination Committee of the Organization.
- (d) As long as the Assembly authorizes the use of the reserve fund of the Special Union as a working capital fund, the Assembly may suspend the application of the provisions of subparagraphs (a), (b), and (c).
- (7) (a) In the headquarters agreement concluded with the country on the territory of which the Organization has its headquarters, it shall be provided that, whenever the working capital fund is insufficient, such country shall grant advances. The amount of those advances and the conditions on which they are granted shall be the subject of separate agreements, in each case, between such country and the Organization.
- (b) The country referred to in subparagraph (a) and the Organization shall each have the right to denounce the obligation to grant advances, by written notification. Denunciation shall take effect three years after the end of the year in which it has been notified.
- (8) The auditing of the accounts shall be effected by one or more of the countries of the Special Union or by external auditors, as provided in the financial regulations. They shall be designated, with their agreement, by the Assembly."

Regulations Under the Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks

as in force on November 1, 2025

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Chapter 1

General Provisions

Rule 1

Abbreviated Expressions

For the purposes of these Regulations,

- (i) “Agreement” means the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks of April 14, 1891, as revised at Stockholm on July 14, 1967, and amended on September 28, 1979;
- (ii) “Protocol” means the Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks, adopted at Madrid on June 27, 1989;
- (iii) “Contracting Party” means any State or intergovernmental organization party to the Protocol;
- (iv) “Contracting State” means a Contracting Party that is a State;
- (v) “Contracting Organization” means a Contracting Party that is an intergovernmental organization;
- (vi) “international registration” means the registration of a mark effected under the Agreement or the Protocol or both, as the case may be;
- (vii) “international application” means an application for international registration filed under the Protocol;
- (viii) [Deleted]
- (ix) [Deleted]
- (x) [Deleted]

- (xi) “applicant” means the natural person or legal entity in whose name the international application is filed;
- (xii) “legal entity” means a corporation, association or other group or organization which, under the law applicable to it, is capable of acquiring rights, assuming obligations and suing or being sued in a court of law;
- (xiii) “basic application” means the application for the registration of a mark that has been filed with the Office of a Contracting Party and that constitutes the basis for the international application for the registration of that mark;
- (xiv) “basic registration” means the registration of a mark that has been effected by the Office of a Contracting Party and that constitutes the basis for the international application for the registration of that mark;
- (xv) “designation” means the request for extension of protection (“territorial extension”) under Article 3~~ter~~(1) or (2) of the Protocol, it also means such extension as recorded in the International Register;
- (xvi) “designated Contracting Party” means a Contracting Party for which the extension of protection (“territorial extension”) has been requested under Article 3~~ter~~(1) or (2) of the Protocol, or in respect of which such extension has been recorded in the International Register;
- (xvii) [Deleted]
- (xviii) [Deleted]
- (xix) “notification of provisional refusal” means a declaration by the Office of a designated Contracting Party, in accordance with Article 5(1) of the Protocol;

- (xix**bis**) “invalidation” means a decision by the competent authority (whether administrative or judicial) of a designated Contracting Party revoking or cancelling the effects, in the territory of that Contracting Party, of an international registration with regard to all or some of the goods or services covered by the designation of the said Contracting Party;

- (xx) “Gazette” means the periodical gazette referred to in Rule 32;

- (xxi) “holder” means the natural person or legal entity in whose name the international registration is recorded in the International Register;

- (xxii) “International Classification of Figurative Elements” means the Classification established by the Vienna Agreement Establishing an International Classification of the Figurative Elements of Marks of June 12, 1973;

- (xxiii) “International Classification of Goods and Services” means the Classification established by the Nice Agreement Concerning the International Classification of Goods and Services for the Purposes of the Registration of Marks of June 15, 1957, as revised at Stockholm on July 14, 1967, and at Geneva on May 13, 1977;

- (xxiv) “International Register” means the official collection of data concerning international registrations maintained by the International Bureau, which data the Protocol or the Regulations require or permit to be recorded, irrespective of the medium in which such data are stored;

- (xxv) “Office” means the Office of a Contracting Party in charge of the registration of marks, or the common Office referred to in Article 9^{quater} of the Protocol;

- (xxvi) “Office of origin” means the Office of origin defined in Article 2(2) of the Protocol;
- (xxvibis) “Contracting Party of the holder” means
- the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin, or
 - where a change of ownership has been recorded or in the case of State succession, the Contracting Party, or one of the Contracting Parties, in respect of which the holder fulfills the conditions under Article 2 of the Protocol, to be the holder of an international registration;
- (xxvii) “official form” means a form established by the International Bureau or any form having the same contents and format;
- (xxviii) “prescribed fee” means the applicable fee set out in the Schedule of Fees;
- (xxix) “Director General” means the Director General of the World Intellectual Property Organization;
- (xxx) “International Bureau” means the International Bureau of the World Intellectual Property Organization.
- (xxxi) “Administrative Instructions” means the Administrative Instructions referred to in Rule 41.

Rule 1*bis*
[Deleted]

Rule 2**Communication with the International Bureau**

Communications addressed to the International Bureau shall be effected as specified in the Administrative Instructions.

Rule 3**Representation Before the International Bureau****(1) *[Representative; Number of Representatives]***

- (a) The applicant or the holder may have a representative before the International Bureau.
- (b) The applicant or the holder may have one representative only. Where the appointment indicates several representatives, only the one indicated first shall be considered to be a representative and be recorded as such.
- (c) Where a partnership or firm composed of attorneys or patent or trademark agents has been indicated as representative to the International Bureau, it shall be regarded as one representative.

(2) *[Appointment of the Representative]*

- (a) The appointment of a representative may be made in the international application or by the new holder of the international registration in a request under Rule 25(1)(a)(i) and shall indicate the name and address, given in accordance with the Administrative Instructions, the electronic mail addresses of the representative and of the applicant or holder where the electronic mail address of the applicant or holder was not indicated in the international application or in a previous request for recording.

(b) The appointment of a representative may also be made in a separate communication, provided it is made on the relevant official form, and it may relate to one or more specified international applications or international registrations of the same applicant or holder. The said form shall be presented to the International Bureau

(i) by the applicant, the holder or the appointed representative, or

(ii) by the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder.

The form shall be signed by the applicant or the holder, or by the Office presenting the request.

(3) *[Irregular Appointment]*

(a) Where the International Bureau considers that the appointment of a representative under paragraph (2) is irregular, it shall notify accordingly the applicant or holder, the purported representative and, if the sender or transmitter is an Office, that Office.

(b) As long as the relevant requirements under paragraph (2) are not complied with, the International Bureau shall send all relevant communications to the applicant or holder but not to the purported representative.

(4) *[Recording and Notification of Appointment of a Representative; Effective Date of Appointment]*

(a) Where the International Bureau finds that the appointment of a representative complies with the applicable requirements, it shall record the fact that the applicant or holder has a representative, as well as the name, address and electronic mail address of the representative, in the International Register. In such a case, the effective date of the appointment shall be the date on which the International Bureau received the international application, request or separate communication in which the representative is appointed.

- (b) The International Bureau shall notify the recording referred to in subparagraph (a) to both the applicant or holder and, in the latter case, the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties, as well as the representative. Where the appointment was made in a separate communication presented through an Office, the International Bureau shall also notify the recording to that Office.

(5) *[Effect of Appointment of a Representative]*

- (a) Except where these Regulations expressly provide otherwise, the signature of a representative recorded under paragraph (4)(a) shall replace the signature of the applicant or holder.
- (b) Except where these Regulations expressly require that an invitation, notification or other communication be addressed to both the applicant or holder and the representative, the International Bureau shall address to the representative recorded under paragraph (4)(a) any invitation, notification or other communication which, in the absence of a representative, would have to be sent to the applicant or holder; any invitation, notification or other communication so addressed to the said representative shall have the same effect as if it had been addressed to the applicant or holder.
- (c) Any communication addressed to the International Bureau by the representative recorded under paragraph (4)(a) shall have the same effect as if it had been addressed to the said Bureau by the applicant or holder.

(6) *[Cancellation of Recording; Effective Date of Cancellation]*

- (a) Any recording under paragraph (4)(a) shall be cancelled where cancellation is requested in a communication signed by the applicant, holder or representative. The recording shall be cancelled *ex officio* by the International Bureau where a new representative is appointed or, in case a change in ownership has been recorded, where no representative is appointed by the new holder of the international registration.

- (b) Subject to subparagraph (c), the cancellation shall be effective from the date on which the International Bureau receives the corresponding communication.
- (c) Where the cancellation is requested by the representative, it shall be effective from the earlier of the following:
 - (i) the date on which the International Bureau receives a communication appointing a new representative;
 - (ii) the date of the expiry of a period of two months counted from the receipt of the request of the representative that the recording be cancelled.

Until the effective date of the cancellation, all communications referred to in paragraph (5)(b) shall be addressed by the International Bureau to both the applicant or holder and the representative.

- (d) The International Bureau shall, upon receipt of a request for cancellation made by the representative, notify accordingly the applicant or holder.
- (e) The International Bureau shall, once the effective date of the cancellation is known, notify the cancellation and its effective date to the representative whose recording has been cancelled, to the applicant or holder and, where the appointment of the representative had been presented through an Office, to that Office.
- (f) Cancellations at the request of the holder or the holder's representative shall also be notified to the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties.

Rule 4**Calculation of Time Limits**

- (1) *[Periods Expressed in Years]* Any period expressed in years shall expire, in the relevant subsequent year, in the month having the same name and on the day having the same number as the month and the day of the event from which the period starts to run, except that, where the event occurred on February 29 and in the relevant subsequent year February ends on the 28th, the period shall expire on February 28.
- (2) *[Periods Expressed in Months]* Any period expressed in months shall expire, in the relevant subsequent month, on the day which has the same number as the day of the event from which the period starts to run, except that, where the relevant subsequent month has no day with the same number, the period shall expire on the last day of that month.
- (3) *[Periods Expressed in Days]* The calculation of any period expressed in days shall start with the day following the day on which the relevant event occurred and shall expire accordingly.
- (4) *[Expiry on a Day on Which the International Bureau or an Office Is Not Open to the Public]* If a period expires on a day on which the International Bureau or the Office concerned is not open to the public, the period shall, notwithstanding paragraphs (1) to (3), expire on the first subsequent day on which the International Bureau or the Office concerned is open to the public.
- (5) *[Indication of the Date of Expiry]* The International Bureau shall, in all cases in which it communicates a time limit, indicate the date of the expiry, according to paragraphs (1) to (3), of the said time limit.

Rule 5

Excuse in Delay in Meeting Time Limits

- (1) *[Excuse in Delay in Meeting Time Limits due to Force Majeure Reasons]* Failure by an interested party to meet a time limit specified in the Regulations to perform an action before the International Bureau shall be excused if the interested party submits evidence showing, to the satisfaction of the International Bureau, that such failure was due to war, revolution, civil disorder, strike, natural calamity, irregularities in postal, delivery or electronic communication services owing to circumstances beyond the control of the interested party or other force majeure reason.
- (i) [Deleted]
 - (ii) [Deleted]
 - (iii) [Deleted]
- (2) [Deleted]
- (i) [Deleted]
 - (ii) [Deleted]
- (3) [Deleted]
- (4) *[Limitation on Excuse]* Failure to meet a time limit shall be excused under this Rule only if the evidence and action referred to in paragraph (1) are received by and performed before the International Bureau as soon as reasonably possible and not later than six months after the expiry of the time limit concerned.

- (5) *[International Application and Subsequent Designation]* Where the International Bureau receives an international application or a subsequent designation beyond the two-month period referred to in Article 3(4) of the Protocol and in Rule 24(6)(b), and the Office concerned indicates that the late receipt resulted from circumstances referred to in paragraph (1), paragraphs (1) and (4) shall apply.

Rule 5bis

Continued Processing

- (1) *[Request]*
- (a) Where an applicant or holder has failed to comply with any of the time limits specified or referred to in Rules 11(2) and (3), 12(7), 20bis(2), 24(5)(b), 26(2), 27bis(3)(c), 34(3)(c)(iii) and 39(1), the International Bureau shall, nevertheless, continue the processing of the international application, subsequent designation, payment or request concerned, if:
 - (i) a request to that effect, signed by the applicant or holder, is presented to the International Bureau on the official form; and
 - (ii) the request is received, the fee specified in the Schedule of Fees is paid and, together with the request, all of the requirements in respect of which the time limit concerned applied are complied with, within two months from the date of expiry of that time limit.
 - (b) A request not complying with items (i) and (ii) of subparagraph (a) shall not be considered as such and the applicant or holder shall be notified to that effect.
- (2) *[Recording and Notification]* The International Bureau shall record in the International Register any continued processing and notify the applicant or holder accordingly.

Rule 6

Languages

- (1) *[International Application]* The international application shall be in English, French or Spanish according to what is prescribed by the Office of origin, it being understood that the Office of origin may allow applicants to choose between English, French and Spanish.
- (2) *[Communications Other than the International Application]* Any communication concerning an international application or an international registration shall, subject to Rule 17(2)(v) and (3), be
 - (i) in English, French or Spanish where such communication is addressed to the International Bureau by the applicant or holder, or by an Office;
 - (ii) in the language applicable under Rule 7(2) where the communication consists of the declaration of intention to use the mark annexed to the international application under Rule 9(5)(f) or to the subsequent designation under Rule 24(3)(b)(i);
 - (iii) in the language of the international application where the communication is a notification addressed by the International Bureau to an Office, unless that Office has notified the International Bureau that all such notifications are to be in English, or are to be in French or are to be in Spanish; where the notification addressed by the International Bureau concerns the recording in the International Register of an international registration, the notification shall indicate the language in which the relevant international application was received by the International Bureau;
 - (iv) in the language of the international application where the communication is a notification addressed by the International Bureau to the applicant or holder, unless that applicant or holder has expressed the wish that all such notifications be in English, or be in French or be in Spanish.

(3) *[Recording and Publication]*

- (a) The recording in the International Register and the publication in the Gazette of the international registration and of any data to be both recorded and published under these Regulations in respect of the international registration shall be in English, French and Spanish. The recording and publication of the international registration shall indicate the language in which the international application was received by the International Bureau.
- (b) Where a first subsequent designation is made in respect of an international registration that, under previous versions of this Rule, has been published only in French, or only in English and French, the International Bureau shall, together with the publication in the Gazette of that subsequent designation, either publish the international registration in English and Spanish and republish the international registration in French, or publish the international registration in Spanish and republish it in English and French, as the case may be. That subsequent designation shall be recorded in the International Register in English, French and Spanish.

(4) *[Translation]*

- (a) The translations needed for the notifications under paragraph (2)(iii) and (iv), and recordings and publications under paragraph (3), shall be made by the International Bureau. The applicant or the holder, as the case may be, may annex to the international application, or to a request for the recording of a subsequent designation or of a change, a proposed translation of any text matter contained in the international application or the request. If the proposed translation is not considered by the International Bureau to be correct, it shall be corrected by the International Bureau after having invited the applicant or the holder to make, within one month from the invitation, observations on the proposed corrections.

- (b) Notwithstanding subparagraph (a), the International Bureau shall not translate the mark. Where, in accordance with Rule 9(4)(b)(iii) or Rule 24(3)(c), the applicant or the holder gives a translation or translations of the mark, the International Bureau shall not check the correctness of any such translations.

Rule 7

Notification of Certain Special Requirements

- (1) [Deleted]
- (2) *[Intention to Use the Mark]* Where a Contracting Party requires, as a designated Contracting Party, a declaration of intention to use the mark, it shall notify that requirement to the Director General. Where that Contracting Party requires the declaration to be signed personally by the applicant and to be made on a separate official form annexed to the international application, the notification shall contain a statement to that effect and shall specify the exact wording of the required declaration. Where the Contracting Party further requires the declaration to be in English, French or Spanish, the notification shall specify the required language.
- (3) *[Notification]*
 - (a) Any notification referred to in paragraph (2) may be made at the time of the deposit by the Contracting Party of its instrument of ratification, acceptance or approval of, or accession to, the Protocol, and the effective date of the notification shall be the same as the date of entry into force of the Protocol with respect to the Contracting Party having made the notification. The notification may also be made later, in which case the notification shall have effect three months after its receipt by the Director General, or at any later date indicated in the notification, in respect of any international registration whose date is the same as or is later than the effective date of the notification.

- (b) Any notification made under paragraph (2) may be withdrawn at any time. The notice of withdrawal shall be addressed to the Director General. The withdrawal shall have effect upon receipt of the notice of withdrawal by the Director General or at any later date indicated in the notice.

Chapter 2

International Applications

Rule 8

Several Applicants

- (1) [Deleted]
- (2) *[Two or More Applicants]* Two or more applicants may jointly file an international application if the basic application was jointly filed by them or the basic registration is jointly owned by them, and if each of them qualifies, in relation to the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin, for filing an international application under Article 2(1) of the Protocol.

Rule 9

Requirements Concerning the International Application

- (1) *[Presentation]* The international application shall be presented to the International Bureau by the Office of origin.
- (2) *[Form and Signature]*
 - (a) The international application shall be presented on the official form.
 - (b) The international application shall be signed by the Office of origin and, where the Office of origin so requires, also by the applicant. Where the Office of origin does not require the applicant to sign the international application but allows that the applicant also sign it, the applicant may do so.

- (3) *[Fees]* The prescribed fees applicable to the international application shall be paid as provided for in Rules 10, 34 and 35.
- (4) *[Contents of the International Application]*
- (a) The international application shall contain or indicate
- (i) the name of the applicant, given in accordance with the Administrative Instructions,
 - (ii) the address, given in accordance with the Administrative Instructions, and the electronic mail address of the applicant,
 - (iii) the name and address, given in accordance with the Administrative Instructions, and the electronic mail address of the representative, if any,
 - (iv) where the applicant wishes, under the Paris Convention for the Protection of Industrial Property, to take advantage of the priority of an earlier filing, a declaration claiming the priority of that earlier filing, together with an indication of the name of the Office where such filing was made and of the date and, where available, the number of that filing, and, where the earlier filing relates to less than all the goods and services listed in the international application, the indication of those goods and services to which the earlier filing relates,
 - (v) a representation of the mark, furnished in accordance with the Administrative Instructions, that shall be in color where color is claimed under item (vii),
 - (vi) where the applicant wishes that the mark be considered as a mark in standard characters, a declaration to that effect,

- (vii) where color is claimed as a distinctive feature of the mark in the basic application or basic registration, or where the applicant wishes to claim color as a distinctive feature of the mark and the mark contained in the basic application or basic registration is in color or is applied to be or is protected in color, an indication that color is claimed and an indication by words of the color or combination of colors claimed,
- (vii*bis*) where the mark that is the subject of the basic application or the basic registration consists of a color or a combination of colors as such, an indication to that effect,
- (viii) where the basic application or the basic registration relates to a three-dimensional mark, the indication “three-dimensional mark,”
- (ix) where the basic application or the basic registration relates to a sound mark, the indication “sound mark,”
- (x) where the basic application or the basic registration relates to a collective mark or a certification mark or a guarantee mark, an indication to that effect,
- (xi) where the basic application or the basic registration contains a description of the mark by words and the Office of origin requires the inclusion of the description, that same description; where the said description is in a language other than the language of the international application, it shall be given in the language of the international application,
- (xii) where the mark consists of or contains matter in characters other than Latin characters or numbers expressed in numerals other than Arabic or Roman numerals, a transliteration of that matter in Latin characters and Arabic numerals; the transliteration into Latin characters shall follow the phonetics of the language of the international application,

- (xiii) the names of the goods and services for which the international registration of the mark is sought, grouped in the appropriate classes of the International Classification of Goods and Services, each group preceded by the number of the class and presented in the order of the classes of that Classification; the goods and services shall be indicated in precise terms, preferably using the words appearing in the Alphabetical List of the said Classification; the international application may contain limitations of the list of goods and services in respect of one or more designated Contracting Parties; the limitation in respect of each Contracting Party may be different,
 - (xiv) the amount of the fees being paid and the method of payment, or instructions to debit the required amount of fees to an account opened with the International Bureau, and the identification of the party effecting the payment or giving the instructions, and
 - (xv) the designated Contracting Parties.
- (b) The international application may also contain,
- (i) where the applicant is a natural person, an indication of the State of which the applicant is a national;
 - (ii) where the applicant is a legal entity, indications concerning the legal nature of that legal entity and the State, and, where applicable, the territorial unit within that State, under the law of which the said legal entity has been organized;
 - (iii) where the mark consists of or contains a word or words that can be translated, a translation of that word or those words into English, French and Spanish, or in any one or two of those languages;

- (iv) where the applicant claims color as a distinctive feature of the mark, an indication by words, in respect of each color, of the principal parts of the mark which are in that color;
- (v) where the applicant wishes to disclaim protection for any element of the mark, an indication of that fact and of the element or elements for which protection is disclaimed;
- (vi) any description of the mark by words or, if the applicant so wishes, the description of the mark by words contained in the basic application or the basic registration, where it has not been provided under paragraph (4)(a)(xi).

(5) *[Additional Contents of the International Application]*

- (a) [Deleted]
- (b) The international application shall contain the number and date of the basic application or basic registration and shall indicate one or more of the following:
 - (i) where the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin is a State, that the applicant is a national of that State;
 - (ii) where the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin is an organization, the name of the Member State of that organization of which the applicant is a national;
 - (iii) that the applicant has a domicile in the territory of the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin;
 - (iv) that the applicant has a real and effective industrial or commercial establishment in the territory of the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin.

- (c) Where the address of the applicant given in accordance with paragraph (4)(a)(ii) is not in the territory of the Contracting Party whose Office is the Office of origin and it has been indicated under subparagraph (a)(i) or (ii) or subparagraph (b)(iii) or (iv) that the applicant has a domicile or an establishment in the territory of that Contracting Party, that domicile or the address of that establishment shall be given in the international application.
- (d) The international application shall contain a declaration by the Office of origin certifying
 - (i) the date on which the Office of origin received the request by the applicant to present the international application to the International Bureau,
 - (ii) that the applicant named in the international application is the same as the applicant named in the basic application or the holder named in the basic registration, as the case may be,
 - (iii) that any indication referred to in paragraph (4)(a)(vii*bis*) to (xi) and appearing in the international application appears also in the basic application or the basic registration, as the case may be,
 - (iv) that the mark that is the subject matter of the international application is the same as in the basic application or the basic registration, as the case may be,

- (v) that, if color is claimed as a distinctive feature of the mark in the basic application or the basic registration, or the mark in the basic application or the basic registration is applied to be or is protected in color, a color claim is included in the international application or that, if color is claimed as a distinctive feature of the mark in the international application without having being claimed in the basic application or basic registration, the mark in the basic application or basic registration is in fact in the color or combination of colors claimed, and
 - (vi) that the goods and services indicated in the international application are covered by the list of goods and services appearing in the basic application or basic registration, as the case may be.
- (e) Where the international application is based on two or more basic applications or basic registrations, the declaration referred to in subparagraph (d) shall be deemed to apply to all those basic applications or basic registrations.
- (f) Where the international application contains the designation of a Contracting Party that has made a notification under Rule 7(2), the international application shall also contain a declaration of intention to use the mark in the territory of that Contracting Party; the declaration shall be considered part of the designation of the Contracting Party requiring it and shall, as required by that Contracting Party,
 - (i) be personally signed by the applicant and be made on a separate official form annexed to the international application, or
 - (ii) be included in the international application.

- (g) Where an international application contains the designation of a Contracting Organization, it may also contain the following indications:
 - (i) where the applicant wishes to claim, under the law of that Contracting Organization, the seniority of one or more earlier marks registered in, or for, a Member State of that Organization, a declaration to that effect, stating the Member State or Member States in or for which the earlier mark is registered, the date from which the relevant registration was effective, the number of the relevant registration and the goods and services for which the earlier mark is registered. Such indications shall be on an official form to be annexed to the international application;
 - (ii) where, under the law of that Contracting Organization, the applicant is required to indicate a second working language before the Office of that Contracting Organization, in addition to the language of the international application, an indication of that second language.

Rule 10

Fees Concerning the International Application

- (1) [Deleted]
- (2) *[Payable Fees]* The international application shall be subject to the payment of the basic fee, the complementary fee and/or the individual fee and, where applicable, the supplementary fee, specified or referred to in item 2 of the Schedule of Fees. Those fees shall be paid for ten years.
- (3) [Deleted]

Rule 11**Irregularities Other than Those Concerning the Classification of Goods and Services or Their Indication**

(1) [Deleted]

(2) *[Irregularities to Be Remedied by the Applicant]*

- (a) If the International Bureau considers that the international application contains irregularities other than those referred to in paragraphs (3), (4) and (6) and in Rules 12 and 13, it shall notify the applicant of the irregularity and at the same time inform the Office of origin.
- (b) Such irregularities may be remedied by the applicant within three months from the date of the notification of the irregularity by the International Bureau. If an irregularity is not remedied within three months from the date of the notification of that irregularity by the International Bureau, the international application shall be considered abandoned and the International Bureau shall notify accordingly and at the same time the applicant and the Office of origin.

(3) *[Irregularity to Be Remedied by the Applicant or by the Office of Origin]*

- (a) Notwithstanding paragraph (2), where the fees payable under Rule 10 have been paid to the International Bureau by the Office of origin and the International Bureau considers that the amount of the fees received is less than the amount required, it shall notify at the same time the Office of origin and the applicant. The notification shall specify the missing amount.
- (b) The missing amount may be paid by the Office of origin or by the applicant within three months from the date of the notification by the International Bureau. If the missing amount is not paid within three months from the date of the notification of the irregularity by the International Bureau, the international application shall be considered abandoned and the International Bureau shall notify accordingly and at the same time the Office of origin and the applicant.

(4) *[Irregularities to Be Remedied by the Office of Origin]*

(a) If the International Bureau

- (i) finds that the international application does not fulfill the requirements of Rule 2 or was not presented on the official form prescribed under Rule 9(2)(a),
- (ii) finds that the international application contains any of the irregularities referred to in Rule 15(1),
- (iii) considers that the international application contains irregularities relating to the entitlement of the applicant to file an international application,
- (iv) considers that the international application contains irregularities relating to the declaration by the Office of origin referred to in Rule 9(5)(d),
- (v) [Deleted]
- (vi) finds that the international application is not signed by the Office of origin, or
- (vii) finds that the international application does not contain the date and number of the basic application or basic registration, as the case may be,

it shall notify the Office of origin and at the same time inform the applicant.

- (b) Such irregularities may be remedied by the Office of origin within three months from the date of notification of the irregularity by the International Bureau. If an irregularity is not remedied within three months from the date of the notification of that irregularity by the International Bureau, the international application shall be considered abandoned and the International Bureau shall notify accordingly and at the same time the Office of origin and the applicant.

- (5) *[Reimbursement of Fees]* Where, in accordance with paragraphs (2)(b), (3) or (4)(b), the international application is considered abandoned, the International Bureau shall refund any fees paid in respect of that application, after deduction of an amount corresponding to one-half of the basic fee referred to in item 2.1.1 of the Schedule of Fees, to the party having paid those fees.
- (6) *[Other Irregularity with Respect to the Designation of a Contracting Party]*
- (a) Where, in accordance with Article 3(4) of the Protocol, an international application is received by the International Bureau within a period of two months from the date of receipt of that international application by the Office of origin and the International Bureau considers that a declaration of intention to use the mark is required according to Rule 9(5)(f) but is missing or does not comply with the applicable requirements, the International Bureau shall promptly notify accordingly and at the same time the applicant and the Office of origin.
- (b) The declaration of intention to use the mark shall be deemed to have been received by the International Bureau together with the international application if the missing or corrected declaration is received by the International Bureau within the period of two months referred to in subparagraph (a).
- (c) The international application shall be deemed not to contain the designation of the Contracting Party for which a declaration of intention to use the mark is required if the missing or corrected declaration is received after the period of two months referred to in subparagraph (b). The International Bureau shall notify accordingly and at the same time the applicant and the Office of origin, reimburse any designation fee already paid in respect of that Contracting Party and indicate that the designation of the said Contracting Party may be effected as a subsequent designation under Rule 24, provided that such designation is accompanied by the required declaration.

- (7) *[International Application Not Considered as Such]* If the international application is presented direct to the International Bureau by the applicant or does not comply with the requirement applicable under Rule 6(1), the international application shall not be considered as such and shall be returned to the sender.

Rule 12

Irregularities with Respect to the Classification of Goods and Services

- (1) *[Proposal for Classification]*
- (a) If the International Bureau considers that the requirements of Rule 9(4)(a)(xiii) are not complied with, it shall make a proposal of its own for the classification and grouping and shall send a notification of its proposal to the Office of origin and at the same time inform the applicant.
 - (b) The notification of the proposal shall also state the amount, if any, of the fees due as a consequence of the proposed classification and grouping.
- (2) *[Opinion Differing from the Proposal]* The Office of origin may communicate to the International Bureau an opinion on the proposed classification and grouping within three months from the date of the notification of the proposal.
- (3) *[Reminder of the Proposal]* If, within two months from the date of the notification referred to in paragraph (1)(a), the Office of origin has not communicated an opinion on the proposed classification and grouping, the International Bureau shall send to the Office of origin and to the applicant a communication reiterating the proposal. The sending of such a communication shall not affect the three-month period referred to in paragraph (2).
- (4) *[Withdrawal of Proposal]* If, in the light of the opinion communicated under paragraph (2), the International Bureau withdraws its proposal, it shall notify the Office of origin accordingly and at the same time inform the applicant.

- (5) *[Modification of Proposal]* If, in the light of the opinion communicated under paragraph (2), the International Bureau modifies its proposal, it shall notify the Office of origin and at the same time inform the applicant of such modification and of any consequent changes in the amount indicated under paragraph (1)(b).
- (6) *[Confirmation of Proposal]* If, notwithstanding the opinion referred to in paragraph (2), the International Bureau confirms its proposal, it shall notify the Office of origin accordingly and at the same time inform the applicant.
- (7) *[Fees]*
- (a) If no opinion has been communicated to the International Bureau under paragraph (2), the amount referred to in paragraph (1)(b) shall be payable within four months from the date of the notification referred to in paragraph (1)(a), failing which the international application shall be considered abandoned and the International Bureau shall notify the Office of origin accordingly and at the same time inform the applicant.
 - (b) If an opinion has been communicated to the International Bureau under paragraph (2), the amount referred to in paragraph (1)(b) or, where applicable, paragraph (5) shall be payable within three months from the date of the communication by the International Bureau of the modification or confirmation of its proposal under paragraph (5) or (6), as the case may be, failing which the international application shall be considered abandoned and the International Bureau shall notify the Office of origin accordingly and at the same time inform the applicant.
 - (c) If an opinion has been communicated to the International Bureau under paragraph (2) and if, in the light of that opinion, the International Bureau withdraws its proposal in accordance with paragraph (4), the amount referred to in paragraph (1)(b) shall not be due.

- (8) *[Reimbursement of Fees]* Where, in accordance with paragraph (7), the international application is considered abandoned, the International Bureau shall refund any fees paid in respect of that application, after deduction of an amount corresponding to one-half of the basic fee referred to in item 2.1.1 of the Schedule of Fees, to the party having paid those fees.
- (8bis) *[Examination of Limitations]* The International Bureau shall examine limitations contained in an international application, applying paragraphs (1)(a) and (2) to (6) *mutatis mutandis*. Where the International Bureau cannot group the goods and services listed in the limitation under the classes of the International Classification of Goods and Services listed in the international application concerned, as amended pursuant to paragraphs (1) to (6), as the case may be, it shall issue an irregularity. Where the irregularity is not remedied within three months from the date of the notification of the irregularity, the limitation shall be deemed not to contain the goods and services concerned.
- (9) *[Classification in the Registration]* Subject to the conformity of the international application with the other applicable requirements, the mark shall be registered with the classification and grouping that the International Bureau considers to be correct.

Rule 13

Irregularities with Respect to the Indication of Goods and Services

- (1) *[Communication of Irregularity by the International Bureau to the Office of Origin]* If the International Bureau considers that any of the goods and services is indicated in the international application by a term that is too vague for the purposes of classification or is incomprehensible or is linguistically incorrect, it shall notify the Office of origin accordingly and at the same time inform the applicant. In the same notification, the International Bureau may suggest a substitute term, or the deletion of the term.

(2) *[Time Allowed to Remedy Irregularity]*

- (a) The Office of origin may make a proposal for remedying the irregularity within three months from the date of the notification referred to in paragraph (1).
- (b) If no proposal acceptable to the International Bureau for remedying the irregularity is made within the period indicated in subparagraph (a), the International Bureau shall include in the international registration the term as appearing in the international application, provided that the Office of origin has specified the class in which such term should be classified; the international registration shall contain an indication to the effect that, in the opinion of the International Bureau, the specified term is too vague for the purposes of classification or is incomprehensible or is linguistically incorrect, as the case may be. Where no class has been specified by the Office of origin, the International Bureau shall delete the said term *ex officio* and shall notify the Office of origin accordingly and at the same time inform the applicant.

Chapter 3

International Registrations

Rule 14

Registration of the Mark in the International Register

- (1) *[Registration of the Mark in the International Register]* Where the International Bureau finds that the international application conforms to the applicable requirements, it shall register the mark in the International Register, notify the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties of the international registration and inform the Office of origin accordingly, and send a certificate to the holder. Where the Office of origin so wishes and has informed the International Bureau accordingly, the certificate shall be sent to the holder through the Office of origin.

- (2) *[Contents of the Registration]* The international registration shall contain
- (i) all the data contained in the international application, except any priority claim under Rule 9(4)(a)(iv) where the date of the earlier filing is more than six months before the date of the international registration,
 - (ii) the date of the international registration,
 - (iii) the number of the international registration,
 - (iv) where the mark can be classified according to the International Classification of Figurative Elements, and unless the international application contains a declaration to the effect that the applicant wishes that the mark be considered as a mark in standard characters, the relevant classification symbols of the said Classification as determined by the International Bureau,
 - (v) [Deleted]
 - (vi) indications annexed to the international application in accordance with Rule 9(5)(g)(i) concerning the Member State or Member States in or for which an earlier mark, for which seniority is claimed, is registered, the date from which the registration of that earlier mark was effective and the number of the relevant registration.

Rule 15**Date of the International Registration**

- (1) *[Irregularities Affecting the Date of the International Registration]* Where the international application received by the International Bureau does not contain all of the following elements:

- (i) indications allowing the identity of the applicant to be established and sufficient to contact the applicant or the representative, if any,
- (ii) the Contracting Parties which are designated,
- (iii) a representation of the mark,
- (iv) the indication of the goods and services for which registration of the mark is sought,

the international registration shall bear the date on which the last of the missing elements reached the International Bureau, provided that, where the last of the missing elements reaches the International Bureau within the two-month time limit referred to in Article 3(4) of the Protocol, the international registration shall bear the date on which the defective international application was received by the Office of origin.

- (2) *[Date of the International Registration in Other Cases]* In any other case, the international registration shall bear the date determined in accordance with Article 3(4) of the Protocol.

Chapter 4

Facts in Contracting Parties Affecting International Registrations

Rule 16

Possibility of Notification of a Provisional Refusal Based on an Opposition Under Article 5(2)(c) of the Protocol

- (1) *[Information Relating to Possible Oppositions and Time Limit for Notifying Provisional Refusal Based on an Opposition]*
- (a) Subject to Article 9sexies(1)(b) of the Protocol, where a declaration has been made by a Contracting Party pursuant to Article 5(2)(b) and (c), first sentence, of the Protocol, the Office of that Contracting Party shall, where it has become apparent with regard to a given international registration designating that Contracting Party that the opposition period will expire too late for any provisional refusal based on an opposition to be notified to the International Bureau within the 18-month time limit referred to in Article 5(2)(b), inform the International Bureau of the number, and the name of the holder, of that international registration.
 - (b) Where, at the time of the communication of the information referred to in subparagraph (a), the dates on which the opposition period begins and ends are known, those dates shall be indicated in the communication. If such dates are not yet known at that time, they shall be communicated to the International Bureau as soon as they are known¹.

¹ In adopting this provision, the Assembly of the Madrid Union understood that if the opposition period is extendable, the Office may communicate only the date the opposition period begins.

- (c) Where subparagraph (a) applies and the Office referred to in the said subparagraph has, before the expiry of the 18-month time limit referred to in the same subparagraph, informed the International Bureau of the fact that the time limit for filing oppositions will expire within the 30 days preceding the expiry of the 18-month time limit and of the possibility that oppositions may be filed during those 30 days, a provisional refusal based on an opposition filed during the said 30 days may be notified to the International Bureau within one month from the date of filing of the opposition.
- (2) *[Recording and Transmittal of the Information]* The International Bureau shall record in the International Register the information received under paragraph (1) and shall transmit that information to the holder.

Rule 17

Provisional Refusal

- (1) *[Notification of Provisional Refusal]*
 - (a) A notification of provisional refusal may comprise a declaration stating the grounds on which the Office making the notification considers that protection cannot be granted in the Contracting Party concerned (“*ex officio* provisional refusal”) or a declaration that protection cannot be granted in the Contracting Party concerned because an opposition has been filed (“provisional refusal based on an opposition”) or both.
 - (b) A notification of provisional refusal shall relate to one international registration, shall be dated and shall be signed by the Office making it.

- (2) *[Content of the Notification]* A notification of provisional refusal shall contain or indicate
- (i) the Office making the notification,
 - (ii) the number of the international registration, preferably accompanied by other indications enabling the identity of the international registration to be confirmed, such as the verbal elements of the mark or the basic application or basic registration number,
 - (iii) [Deleted]
 - (iv) all the grounds on which the provisional refusal is based, together with a reference to the corresponding essential provisions of the law,
 - (v) where the grounds on which the provisional refusal is based relate to a mark which has been the subject of an application or registration and with which the mark that is the subject of the international registration appears to be in conflict, the filing date and number, the priority date, if any, the registration date and number, if available, the name of the owner and of the representative, if any, their addresses, if possible, and a representation of the former mark or an indication of how to access that representation, together with the list of all or the relevant goods and services in the application or registration of the former mark, it being understood that the said list may be in the language of the said application or registration,

- (vi) either that the grounds on which the provisional refusal is based affect all the goods and services or an indication of the goods and services which are affected, or are not affected, by the provisional refusal,
 - (vii) the time limit, which shall be no less than two months², for filing a request for review of, or appeal against, the *ex officio* provisional refusal or the provisional refusal based on an opposition and, as the case may be, for filing a response to the opposition,
 - (viii) where the time limit referred to in paragraph (2)(vii) begins on a date other than the date on which the International Bureau transmits a copy of the notification to the holder or the date on which the holder receives said copy, an indication of the date on which the said time limit begins and ends,
 - (ix) the authority with which such request for review, appeal or response should be filed, and
 - (x) an indication, where applicable, that the request for review, the appeal or the response has to be filed through the intermediary of a representative whose address is within the territory of the Contracting Party whose Office has pronounced the refusal.
- (3) *[Additional Requirements Concerning a Notification of Provisional Refusal Based on an Opposition]* Where the provisional refusal of protection is based on an opposition, or on an opposition and other grounds, the notification shall, in addition to complying with the requirements referred to in paragraph (2), contain an indication of that fact and the name of the opponent and of the representative, if any and, if possible, their addresses; however, notwithstanding paragraph (2)(v), the Office making the notification must, where the

² In adopting this provision, the Assembly of the Madrid Union understood that Contracting Parties whose legislation provides for a time limit of 60 calendar or consecutive days meet the requirement specified in Rule 17(2)(vii).

opposition is based on a mark which has been the subject of an application or registration, communicate the list of the goods and services on which the opposition is based and may, in addition, communicate the complete list of goods and services of that earlier application or registration, it being understood that the said lists may be in the language of the earlier application or registration.

- (4) *[Recording; Transmittal of Copies of Notifications]* The International Bureau shall record the provisional refusal in the International Register together with the data contained in the notification, with an indication of the date on which the notification was sent or is regarded under Rule 18(1)(d) as having been sent to the International Bureau and shall transmit a copy thereof to the Office of origin, if that Office has informed the International Bureau that it wishes to receive such copies, and, at the same time, to the holder.
- (5) *[Declarations Relating to the Possibility of Review]*
- (a) [Deleted]
 - (b) [Deleted]
 - (c) [Deleted]
 - (d) The Office of a Contracting Party may, in a declaration, notify the Director General that, in accordance with the law of the said Contracting Party,
 - (i) any provisional refusal that has been notified to the International Bureau is subject to review by the said Office, whether or not such review has been requested by the holder, and

- (ii) the decision taken on the said review may be the subject of a further review or appeal before the Office.

Where this declaration applies and the Office is not in a position to communicate the said decision directly to the holder of the international registration concerned, the Office shall, notwithstanding the fact that all procedures before the said Office relating to the protection of the mark may not have been completed, send the statement referred to in Rule 18*ter*(2) or (3) to the International Bureau immediately following the said decision. Any further decision affecting the protection of the mark shall be sent to the International Bureau in accordance with Rule 18*ter*(4).

- (e) The Office of a Contracting Party may, in a declaration, notify the Director General that, in accordance with the law of the said Contracting Party, any *ex officio* provisional refusal that has been notified to the International Bureau is not open to review before the said Office. Where this declaration applies, any *ex officio* notification of a provisional refusal by the said Office shall be deemed to include a statement in accordance with Rule 18*ter*(2)(ii) or (3).

(6) [Deleted]

- (7) *[Information Concerning the Time Limit to Respond to a Provisional Refusal]* Contracting Parties shall notify the International Bureau of the length of the time limit referred to in paragraph (2)(vii) and of the way in which this time limit shall be calculated.

Rule 18

Irregular Notifications of Provisional Refusal

(1) *[General]*

- (a) A notification of provisional refusal communicated by the Office of a designated Contracting Party shall not be regarded as such by the International Bureau
 - (i) if it does not contain any international registration number, unless other indications contained in the notification permit the international registration to which the provisional refusal relates to be identified,
 - (ii) if it does not indicate any grounds for refusal, or
 - (iii) if it is sent too late to the International Bureau, that is, if it is sent after the expiry of the time limit applicable under Article 5(2)(a) or, subject to Article 9sexies(1)(b) of the Protocol, under Article 5(2)(b) or (c)(ii) of the Protocol, from the date on which the International Bureau sent the notification of the international registration or of the designation made subsequently.
- (b) Where subparagraph (a) applies, the International Bureau shall nevertheless transmit a copy of the notification to the holder, shall inform, at the same time, the holder and the Office that sent the notification that the notification of provisional refusal is not regarded as such by the International Bureau, and shall indicate the reasons therefor.
- (c) If the notification
 - (i) is not signed on behalf of the Office which communicated it, or does not otherwise comply with the requirements of Rule 2 or with the requirement applicable under Rule 6(2),

- (ii) does not contain, where applicable, the details of the mark with which the mark that is the subject of the international registration appears to be in conflict (Rule 17(2)(v) and (3)),
- (iii) does not comply with the requirements of Rule 17(2)(vi), or
- (iv) [Deleted]
- (v) [Deleted]
- (vi) does not contain, where applicable, the name and address of the opponent and the indication of the goods and services on which the opposition is based (Rule 17(3)),

the International Bureau shall, nonetheless record the provisional refusal in the International Register. The International Bureau shall invite the Office that communicated the provisional refusal to send a rectified notification within two months from the invitation and shall transmit to the holder copies of the irregular notification and of the invitation sent to the Office concerned.

- (d) Where the notification does not comply with the requirements of Rule 17(2)(vii) to (x), the provisional refusal shall not be regarded as such and shall not be recorded in the International Register. The International Bureau shall inform the Office that communicated the provisional refusal of this fact, indicate the reasons therefor and transmit to the holder a copy of the defective notification. However, if the Office sends a rectified notification within two months from the date on which the International Bureau informed this Office of the defective notification, the rectified notification shall be regarded, for the purposes of Article 5 of the Protocol, as having been sent on the date on which the defective notification had been sent to the International Bureau and shall be recorded in the International Register.

- (e) Any rectified notification shall, where the applicable law so permits, indicate a new time limit and provide information, in accordance with Rule 17(2)(vii) to (x), for filing a request for review of, or appeal against, the *ex officio* provisional refusal or the provisional refusal based on an opposition and, as the case may be, for filing a response to the opposition.
 - (f) The International Bureau shall transmit a copy of any rectified notification to the holder.
- (2) *[Notification of Provisional Refusal Made Under Article 5(2)(c) of the Protocol]*
 - (a) [Deleted]
 - (b) Paragraph (1)(a) shall apply to determine whether the time limit before the expiry of which the Office of the Contracting Party concerned must give the International Bureau the information referred to in Article 5(2)(c)(i) of the Protocol has been complied with. If such information is given after the expiry of that time limit, it shall be regarded as not having been given and the International Bureau shall inform the Office concerned accordingly.
 - (c) Where the notification of provisional refusal based on an opposition is made under Article 5(2)(c)(ii) of the Protocol without the requirements of Article 5(2)(c)(i) of the Protocol having been complied with, it shall not be regarded as a notification of provisional refusal. In such a case, the International Bureau shall nevertheless transmit a copy of the notification to the holder, shall inform, at the same time, the holder and the Office that sent the notification that the notification of provisional refusal is not regarded as such by the International Bureau, and shall indicate the reasons therefor.

Rule 18bis**Interim Status of a Mark in a Designated Contracting Party**

- (1) *[Ex Officio Examination Completed but Opposition or Observations by Third Parties Still Possible]*
- (a) An Office which has not communicated a notification of provisional refusal may, within the period applicable under Article 5(2)(a) or (b) of the Protocol, send to the International Bureau a statement to the effect that the *ex officio* examination has been completed and that the Office has found no grounds for refusal but that the protection of the mark is still subject to opposition or observations by third parties, with an indication of the date by which such oppositions or observations may be filed³.
 - (b) An Office which has communicated a notification of provisional refusal may send to the International Bureau a statement to the effect that the *ex officio* examination has been completed but that the protection of the mark is still subject to opposition or observations by third parties, with an indication of the date by which such oppositions or observations may be filed.
- (2) *[Recording, Information to the Holder and Transmittal of Copies]* The International Bureau shall record any statement received under this Rule in the International Register, inform the holder accordingly and, where the statement was communicated, or can be reproduced, in the form of a specific document, transmit a copy of that document to the holder.

³ Interpretative statement endorsed by the Assembly of the Madrid Union:
“The references in Rule 18bis to observations by third parties apply only to those Contracting Parties whose legislation provides for such observations.”

Rule 18^{ter}

Final Disposition on Status of a Mark in a Designated Contracting Party

- (1) *[Statement of Grant of Protection Where No Notification of Provisional Refusal Has Been Communicated]*⁴ When, before the expiry of the period applicable under Article 5(2)(a), (b) or (c) of the Protocol, all procedures before an Office have been completed and there is no ground for that Office to refuse protection, that Office shall, as soon as possible and before the expiry of that period, send to the International Bureau a statement to the effect that protection is granted to the mark that is the subject of the international registration in the Contracting Party concerned⁵.
- (2) *[Statement of Grant of Protection Following a Provisional Refusal]* Except where it sends a statement under paragraph (3), an Office which has communicated a notification of provisional refusal shall, once all procedures before the said Office relating to the protection of the mark have been completed, send to the International Bureau either
- (i) a statement to the effect that the provisional refusal is withdrawn and that protection of the mark is granted, in the Contracting Party concerned, for all goods and services for which protection has been requested, or
 - (ii) a statement indicating the goods and services for which protection of the mark is granted in the Contracting Party concerned.

⁴ In adopting this provision, the Assembly of the Madrid Union understood that a statement of grant of protection could concern several international registrations and take the form of a list, communicated electronically or on paper, that permits identification of these international registrations.

⁵ In adopting paragraphs (1) and (2) of this rule, the Assembly of the Madrid Union understood that where Rule 34(3) applies, the grant of protection will be subject to the payment of the second part of the fee.

- (3) *[Confirmation of Total Provisional Refusal]* An Office which has sent to the International Bureau a notification of a total provisional refusal shall, once all procedures before the said Office relating to the protection of the mark have been completed and the Office has decided to confirm refusal of the protection of the mark in the Contracting Party concerned for all goods and services, send to the International Bureau a statement to that effect.
- (4) *[Further Decision]* Where a notification of provisional refusal has not been sent within the applicable time limit under Article 5(2) of the Protocol, or, where following the sending of a statement under paragraph (1), (2) or (3), a further decision, taken by the Office or other authority, affects the protection of the mark, the Office shall, to the extent that it is aware of that decision, without prejudice to Rule 19, send to the International Bureau a further statement indicating the status of the mark and, where applicable, the goods and services for which the mark is protected in the Contracting Party concerned⁶.
- (5) *[Recording, Information to the Holder and Transmittal of Copies]* The International Bureau shall record any statement received under this Rule in the International Register, inform the holder accordingly and, where the statement was communicated, or can be reproduced, in the form of a specific document, transmit a copy of that document to the holder.

⁶ Interpretative statement endorsed by the Assembly of the Madrid Union:

"The reference in Rule 18ter(4) to a further decision that affects the protection of the mark includes also the case where that further decision is taken by the Office, for example in the case of *restitutio in integrum*, notwithstanding the fact that the Office has already stated that the procedures before the Office have been completed."

Rule 19

Invalidations in Designated Contracting Parties

- (1) *[Contents of the Notification of Invalidity]* Where the effects of an international registration are invalidated in a designated Contracting Party under Article 5(6) of the Protocol and the invalidation is no longer subject to appeal, the Office of the Contracting Party whose competent authority has pronounced the invalidation shall notify the International Bureau accordingly. The notification shall contain or indicate
- (i) the authority which pronounced the invalidation,
 - (ii) the fact that the invalidation is no longer subject to appeal,
 - (iii) the number of the international registration,
 - (iv) the name of the holder,
 - (v) if the invalidation does not concern all the goods and services, those in respect of which the invalidation has been pronounced or those in respect of which the invalidation has not been pronounced, and
 - (vi) the date on which the invalidation was pronounced and, where possible, its effective date.
- (2) *[Recording of the Invalidity and Information to the Holder and the Office Concerned]*
- (a) The International Bureau shall record the invalidation in the International Register, together with the data contained in the notification of invalidation, and shall inform accordingly the holder. The International Bureau shall also inform the Office that communicated the notification of invalidation of the date on which the invalidation was recorded in the International Register if that Office has requested to receive such information.

- (b) The invalidation shall be recorded as of the date of receipt by the International Bureau of a notification complying with the applicable requirements.

Rule 20

Restriction of the Holder's Right of Disposal

(1) *[Communication of Information]*

- (a) The holder of an international registration or the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder may inform the International Bureau that the holder's right to dispose of the international registration has been restricted and, if appropriate, indicate the Contracting Parties concerned.
- (b) The Office of any designated Contracting Party may inform the International Bureau that the holder's right of disposal has been restricted in respect of the international registration in the territory of that Contracting Party.
- (c) Information given in accordance with subparagraph (a) or (b) shall consist of a summary statement of the main facts concerning the restriction.

(2) *[Partial or Total Removal of Restriction]* Where the International Bureau has been informed of a restriction of the holder's right of disposal in accordance with paragraph (1), the party that communicated the information shall also inform the International Bureau of any partial or total removal of that restriction.

(3) *[Recording]*

- (a) The International Bureau shall record the information communicated under paragraphs (1) and (2) in the International Register and shall inform accordingly the holder, the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder and the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties concerned.

- (b) The information communicated under paragraphs (1) and (2) shall be recorded as of the date of its receipt by the International Bureau, provided that the communication complies with the applicable requirements.

Rule 20bis

Licenses

(1) *[Request for the Recording of a License]*

- (a) A request for the recording of a license shall be presented to the International Bureau on the relevant official form by the holder or, if the Office admits such presentation, by the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder or the Office of a Contracting Party with respect to which the license is granted.
- (b) The request shall indicate
 - (i) the number of the international registration concerned,
 - (ii) the name of the holder,
 - (iii) the name and address of the licensee, given in accordance with the Administrative Instructions, and the electronic mail address of the licensee,
 - (iv) the designated Contracting Parties with respect to which the license is granted,
 - (v) that the license is granted for all the goods and services covered by the international registration, or the goods and services for which the license is granted, grouped in the appropriate classes of the International Classification of Goods and Services,
 - (vi) the electronic mail address of the holder where this address was not indicated in the international application or in a previous request for recording,

- (vii) the electronic mail address of the representative, if any, where this address was not indicated in the request for the recording of the appointment of the representative as such.
- (c) The request may also indicate
 - (i) where the licensee is a natural person, the State of which the licensee is a national,
 - (ii) where the licensee is a legal entity, the legal nature of that entity and the State and, where applicable, the territorial unit within that State, under the law of which the said legal entity has been organized,
 - (iii) that the license concerns only a part of the territory of a specified designated Contracting Party,
 - (iv) where the licensee has a representative, the name and address of the representative, given in accordance with the Administrative Instructions, and the electronic mail address of the representative,
 - (v) where the license is an exclusive license or a sole license, that fact,⁷
 - (vi) where applicable, the duration of the license.
- (d) The request shall be signed by the holder or by the Office through which it is presented.

⁷

Interpretative statement endorsed by the Assembly of the Madrid Union:

"Where a request to record a license does not include the indication, provided for in Rule 20*bis*(1)(c)(v), that the license is exclusive or sole, it may be considered that the license is non-exclusive."

(2) *[Irregular Request]*

- (a) If the request for the recording of a license does not comply with the requirements of paragraph (1)(a), (b) and (d), the International Bureau shall notify that fact to the holder, the licensee or the representative of the licensee, if any, and, if the request was presented by an Office, to that Office.
- (b) If the irregularity is not remedied within three months from the date of the notification of the irregularity by the International Bureau, the request shall be considered abandoned, and the International Bureau shall notify accordingly and at the same time the holder, the licensee or the representative of the licensee, if any, and, if the request was presented by an Office, that Office, and refund any fees paid, after deduction of an amount corresponding to one-half of the relevant fees referred to in item 7 of the Schedule of Fees, to the party having paid those fees.

(3) *[Recording and Notification]*

- (a) Where the request complies with the requirements of paragraph (1)(a), (b) and (d), the International Bureau shall record the license in the International Register, together with the information contained in the request, shall notify accordingly the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties in respect of which the license is granted and shall inform at the same time the holder, the licensee or the representative of the licensee, if any, and, if the request was presented by an Office, that Office.
- (b) The license shall be recorded as of the date of receipt by the International Bureau of a request complying with the applicable requirements.
- (c) Notwithstanding subparagraph (b), where continued processing has been recorded under Rule 5*bis*, the license shall be recorded in the International Register as of the date of expiry of the time limit specified in paragraph (2)(b).

- (4) *[Amendment or Cancellation of the Recording of a License]*
Paragraphs (1) to (3) shall apply *mutatis mutandis* to a request for the amendment or cancellation of the recording of a license.
- (5) *[Declaration that the Recording of a Given License Has No Effect]*
- (a) The Office of a designated Contracting Party which is notified by the International Bureau of the recording of a license in respect of that Contracting Party may declare that such recording has no effect in the said Contracting Party.
 - (b) The declaration referred to in subparagraph (a) shall indicate
 - (i) the reasons for which the recording of the license has no effect,
 - (ii) where the declaration does not affect all the goods and services to which the license relates, those which are affected by the declaration or those which are not affected by the declaration,
 - (iii) the corresponding essential provisions of the law, and
 - (iv) whether such declaration may be subject to review or appeal.
 - (c) The declaration referred to in subparagraph (a) shall be sent to the International Bureau before the expiry of 18 months from the date on which the notification referred to in paragraph (3) was sent to the Office concerned.
 - (d) The International Bureau shall record in the International Register any declaration made in accordance with subparagraph (c) and shall notify accordingly the party (holder or Office) that presented the request to record the license and the licensee or the representative of the licensee, if any. The declaration shall be recorded as of the date of receipt by the International Bureau of a communication complying with the applicable requirements.

- (e) Any final decision relating to a declaration made in accordance with subparagraph (c) shall be notified to the International Bureau which shall record it in the International Register and notify accordingly the party (holder or Office) that presented the request to record the license and the licensee or the representative of the licensee, if any.
- (6) *[Declaration that the Recording of Licenses in the International Register Has No Effect in a Contracting Party]*
- (a) The Office of a Contracting Party the law of which does not provide for the recording of trademark licenses may notify the Director General that the recording of licenses in the International Register has no effect in that Contracting Party.
 - (b) The Office of a Contracting Party the law of which provides for the recording of trademark licenses may, before the date on which this Rule comes into force or the date on which the said Contracting Party becomes bound by the Protocol, notify the Director General that the recording of licenses in the International Register has no effect in that Contracting Party. Such notification may be withdrawn at any time⁸.

⁸ Interpretative statement endorsed by the Assembly of the Madrid Union:
“Subparagraph (a) of Rule 20bis(6) deals with the case of a notification by a Contracting Party whose law does not provide for the recording of trademark licenses; such a notification may be made at any time; subparagraph (b) on the other hand deals with the case of a notification by a Contracting Party whose law does provide for the recording of trademark licenses but which is unable at present to give effect to the recording of a license in the International Register; this latter notification, which may be withdrawn at any time, may only be made before this Rule has come into force or before the Contracting Party has become bound by the Agreement or the Protocol.”

Rule 21**Replacement of a National or Regional Registration by an International Registration**

- (1) *[Request and Notification]* From the date of the notification of the international registration or of the subsequent designation, as the case may be, the holder may present directly to the Office of a designated Contracting Party a request for that Office to take note of the international registration in its Register, in accordance with Article 4*bis*(2) of the Protocol. Where, following the said request, the Office has taken note in its Register that a national or a regional registration or registrations, as the case may be, have been replaced by the international registration, that Office shall notify the International Bureau accordingly. Such notification shall indicate
- (i) the number of the international registration concerned,
 - (ii) where the replacement concerns only one or some of the goods and services listed in the international registration, those goods and services, and
 - (iii) the filing date and number, the registration date and number, and, if any, the priority date of the national or regional registration or registrations which have been replaced by the international registration.

The notification may also include information relating to any other rights acquired by virtue of that national or regional registration or registrations.

- (2) *[Recording]*
- (a) The International Bureau shall record the indications notified under paragraph (1) in the International Register and shall inform the holder accordingly.
 - (b) The indications notified under paragraph (1) shall be recorded as of the date of receipt by the International Bureau of a notification complying with the applicable requirements.

(3) *[Further Details Concerning Replacement]*

- (a) Protection to the mark that is the subject of an international registration may not be refused, even partially, based on a national or regional registration which is deemed replaced by that international registration.
- (b) A national or regional registration and the international registration that has replaced it shall be able to coexist. The holder may not be required to renounce or request the cancellation of a national or regional registration which is deemed replaced by an international registration and shall be allowed to renew that registration, if the holder so wishes, in accordance with the applicable national or regional law.
- (c) Before taking note in its Register, the Office of a designated Contracting Party shall examine the request referred to in paragraph (1) to determine whether the conditions specified in Article 4*bis*(1) of the Protocol have been met.
- (d) The goods and services concerned with replacement, listed in the national or regional registration, shall be covered by those listed in the international registration. Replacement may concern only some of the goods and services listed in the national or regional registration.
- (e) A national or regional registration is deemed replaced by an international registration as from the date on which that international registration takes effect in the designated Contracting Party concerned, in accordance with Article 4(1)(a) of the Protocol.

Rule 21bis**Other Facts Concerning Seniority Claim**

- (1) *[Final Refusal of Seniority Claim]* Where a claim of seniority has been recorded in the International Register in respect of the designation of a Contracting Organization, the Office of that Organization shall notify the International Bureau of any final decision refusing, in whole or in part, the validity of such claim.
- (2) *[Seniority Claimed Subsequent to the International Registration]* Where the holder of an international registration designating a Contracting Organization has, under the law of such Contracting Organization, claimed directly with the Office of that Organization the seniority of one or more earlier marks registered in, or for, a Member State of that Organization, and where such claim has been accepted by the Office concerned, that Office shall notify that fact to the International Bureau. Such notification shall indicate:
 - (i) the number of the international registration concerned, and
 - (ii) the Member State or Member States in or for which the earlier mark is registered, together with the date from which the registration of that earlier mark was effective and the number of the relevant registration.
- (3) *[Other Decisions Affecting Seniority Claim]* The Office of a Contracting Organization shall notify the International Bureau of any further final decision, including withdrawal and cancellation, affecting a claim to seniority which has been recorded in the International Register.
- (4) *[Recording in the International Register]* The International Bureau shall record in the International Register the information notified under paragraphs (1) to (3).

Rule 22

Ceasing of Effect of the Basic Application, of the Registration Resulting Therefrom, or of the Basic Registration

(1) *[Notification Relating to Ceasing of Effect of the Basic Application, of the Registration Resulting Therefrom, or of the Basic Registration]*

- (a) Where Article 6(3) and (4) of the Protocol apply, the Office of origin shall notify the International Bureau accordingly and shall indicate
 - (i) the number of the international registration,
 - (ii) the name of the holder,
 - (iii) the facts and decisions affecting the basic registration, or, where the international registration concerned is based on a basic application which has not resulted in a registration, the facts and decisions affecting the basic application, or, where the international registration is based on a basic application which has resulted in a registration, the facts and decisions affecting that registration, and the effective date of those facts and decisions, and
 - (iv) where the said facts and decisions affect the international registration only with respect to some of the goods and services, those goods and services which are affected by the facts and decisions or those which are not affected by the facts and decisions.
- (b) Where a proceeding referred to in item (i), (ii) or (iii) of Article 6(3) of the Protocol began before the expiry of the five-year period but has not, before the expiry of that period, resulted in the final decision referred to in the second sentence of Article 6(3) of the Protocol or in the withdrawal or renunciation referred to in the third sentence of Article 6(3) of the Protocol, the Office of origin shall, where it is aware thereof and as soon as possible after the expiry of the said period, notify the International Bureau accordingly.

- (c) Once the proceeding referred to in subparagraph (b) has resulted in the final decision referred to in the second sentence of Article 6(3) of the Protocol or in the withdrawal or renunciation referred to in the third sentence of Article 6(3) of the Protocol, the Office of origin shall, where it is aware thereof, promptly notify the International Bureau accordingly and shall give the indications referred to in subparagraph (a)(i) to (iv). Where the proceeding referred to in subparagraph (b) has been completed and has not resulted in any of the aforesaid final decision, withdrawal or renunciation, the Office of origin shall, where it is aware thereof or at the request of the holder, promptly notify the International Bureau accordingly.

(2) *[Recording and Transmittal of the Notification; Cancellation of the International Registration]*

- (a) The International Bureau shall record any notification referred to in paragraph (1) in the International Register and shall transmit a copy of the notification to the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties and to the holder.
- (b) Where any notification referred to in paragraph (1)(a) or (c) requests cancellation of the international registration and complies with the requirements of that paragraph, the International Bureau shall cancel, to the extent applicable, the international registration in the International Register. The International Bureau shall also cancel, to the extent applicable, international registrations resulting from partial change in ownership or division recorded under the international registration that has been cancelled, following the above-mentioned notification, and those resulting from their merger.
- (c) Where the international registration has been cancelled in the International Register in accordance with subparagraph (b), the International Bureau shall notify the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties and the holder of the following:
 - (i) the date on which the international registration was cancelled in the International Register;

- (ii) where the cancellation concerns all goods and services, that fact;
- (iii) where the cancellation concerns only some of the goods and services, the goods and services indicated under paragraph (1)(a)(iv).

Rule 23

Division or Merger of the Basic Applications, of the Registrations Resulting Therefrom, or of the Basic Registrations

- (1) *[Notification of the Division of the Basic Application or Merger of the Basic Applications]* Where, during the five-year period referred to in Article 6(3) of the Protocol, the basic application is divided into two or more applications, or several basic applications are merged into a single application, the Office of origin shall notify the International Bureau accordingly and shall indicate
 - (i) the number of the international registration or, if the international registration has not yet been effected, the number of the basic application,
 - (ii) the name of the holder or applicant,
 - (iii) the number of each application resulting from the division or the number of the application resulting from the merger.
- (2) *[Recording and Notification by the International Bureau]* The International Bureau shall record the notification referred to in paragraph (1) in the International Register and shall notify the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties and, at the same time, the holder.

- (3) *[Division or Merger of Registrations Resulting from Basic Applications or of Basic Registrations]* Paragraphs (1) and (2) shall apply, *mutatis mutandis*, to the division of any registration or merger of any registrations which resulted from the basic application or applications during the five-year period referred to in Article 6(3) of the Protocol and to the division of the basic registration or merger of the basic registrations during the five-year period referred to in Article 6(3) of the Protocol.

Rule 23bis

Communications from the Offices of the Designated Contracting Parties Sent Through the International Bureau

- (1) *[Communications Not Covered by These Regulations]* The Office of a designated Contracting Party may request the International Bureau to transmit communications concerning an international registration to the holder on its behalf.
- (2) *[Format of the Communication]* The International Bureau shall establish the format in which the communication referred to in paragraph (1) shall be sent by the Office concerned.
- (3) *[Transmission to the Holder]* The International Bureau shall transmit the communication referred to in paragraph (1) to the holder, in the format established by the International Bureau, without examining its contents or recording it in the International Register.

Chapter 5

Subsequent Designations; Changes

Rule 24

Designation Subsequent to the International Registration

(1) *[Entitlement]*

- (a) A Contracting Party may be the subject of a designation made subsequent to the international registration (hereinafter referred to as “subsequent designation”) where, at the time of that designation, the holder fulfills the conditions under Article 2 of the Protocol to be the holder of an international registration.
- (b) [Deleted]
- (c) [Deleted]

(2) *[Presentation; Form and Signature]*

- (a) A subsequent designation shall be presented to the International Bureau by the holder or by the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder; however,
 - (i) [Deleted]
 - (ii) [Deleted]
 - (iii) where paragraph (7) applies, the subsequent designation resulting from conversion must be presented by the Office of the Contracting Organization.

- (b) The subsequent designation shall be presented on the official form. Where it is presented by the holder, it shall be signed by the holder. Where it is presented by an Office, it shall be signed by that Office and, where the Office so requires, also by the holder. Where it is presented by an Office and that Office, without requiring that the holder also sign it, allows that the holder also sign it, the holder may do so.

(3) *[Contents]*

- (a) Subject to paragraph (7)(b), the subsequent designation shall contain or indicate
 - (i) the number of the international registration concerned,
 - (ii) the name of the holder,
 - (iii) the Contracting Party that is designated,
 - (iv) where the subsequent designation is for all the goods and services listed in the international registration concerned, that fact, or, where the subsequent designation is for only part of the goods and services listed in the international registration concerned, those goods and services,
 - (v) the amount of the fees being paid and the method of payment, or instructions to debit the required amount of fees to an account opened with the International Bureau, and the identification of the party effecting the payment or giving the instructions,
 - (vi) where the subsequent designation is presented by an Office, the date on which it was received by that Office,
 - (vii) the electronic mail address of the holder where this address was not indicated in the international application or in a previous request for recording, and,

- (viii) the electronic mail address of the representative, if any, where this address was not indicated in the request for the recording of the appointment of the representative as such.
 - (b) Where the subsequent designation concerns a Contracting Party that has made a notification under Rule 7(2), that subsequent designation shall also contain a declaration of intention to use the mark in the territory of that Contracting Party; the declaration shall, as required by the said Contracting Party,
 - (i) be personally signed by the holder and be made on a separate official form annexed to the subsequent designation, or
 - (ii) be included in the subsequent designation.
 - (c) The subsequent designation may also contain
 - (i) the indications and translation or translations, as the case may be, referred to in Rule 9(4)(b),
 - (ii) a request that the subsequent designation take effect after the recording of a change or a cancellation in respect of the international registration concerned or after the renewal of the international registration,
 - (iii) where the subsequent designation concerns a Contracting Organization, the indications referred to in Rule 9(5)(g)(i), which shall be on a separate official form to be annexed to the subsequent designation, and in Rule 9(5)(g)(ii).
 - (d) [Deleted]
- (4) *[Fees]* The subsequent designation shall be subject to the payment of the fees specified or referred to in item 5 of the Schedule of Fees.

(5) *[Irregularities]*

- (a) If the subsequent designation does not comply with the applicable requirements, and subject to paragraph (10), the International Bureau shall notify that fact to the holder and, if the subsequent designation was presented by an Office, that Office.
- (b) If the irregularity is not remedied within three months from the date of the notification of the irregularity by the International Bureau, the subsequent designation shall be considered abandoned, and the International Bureau shall notify accordingly and at the same time the holder and, if the subsequent designation was presented by an Office, that Office, and refund any fees paid, after deduction of an amount corresponding to one-half of the basic fee referred to in item 5.1 of the Schedule of Fees, to the party having paid those fees.
- (c) Notwithstanding subparagraphs (a) and (b), where the requirements of paragraph (3)(b)(i) are not complied with in respect of one or more of the designated Contracting Parties, the subsequent designation shall be deemed not to contain the designation of those Contracting Parties, and any complementary or individual fees already paid in respect of those Contracting Parties shall be reimbursed. Where the requirements of paragraph (3)(b)(i) are complied with in respect of none of the designated Contracting Parties, subparagraph (b) shall apply.

(6) *[Date of Subsequent Designation]*

- (a) A subsequent designation presented by the holder direct to the International Bureau shall, subject to subparagraph (c)(i), bear the date of its receipt by the International Bureau.

- (b) A subsequent designation presented to the International Bureau by an Office shall, subject to subparagraph (c)(i), (d) and (e), bear the date on which it was received by that Office, provided that the said designation has been received by the International Bureau within a period of two months from that date. If the subsequent designation has not been received by the International Bureau within that period, it shall, subject to subparagraph (c)(i), (d) and (e), bear the date of its receipt by the International Bureau.
- (c) Where the subsequent designation does not comply with the applicable requirements and the irregularity is remedied within three months from the date of the notification referred to in paragraph (5)(a),
 - (i) the subsequent designation shall, where the irregularity concerns any of the requirements referred to in paragraph (3)(a)(i), (iii) and (iv) and (b)(i), bear the date on which that designation is put in order, unless the said designation was presented to the International Bureau by an Office and the irregularity is remedied within the period of two months referred to in subparagraph (b); in the latter case, the subsequent designation shall bear the date on which it was received by the said Office;
 - (ii) the date applicable under subparagraph (a) or (b), as the case may be, shall not be affected by an irregularity concerning requirements other than those which are referred to in paragraph (3)(a)(i), (iii) and (iv) and (b)(i).
- (d) Notwithstanding subparagraphs (a), (b) and (c), where the subsequent designation contains a request made in accordance with paragraph (3)(c)(ii), it may bear a date which is later than that resulting from subparagraph (a), (b) or (c).

- (e) Where a subsequent designation results from conversion in accordance with paragraph (7), that subsequent designation shall bear the date on which the designation of the Contracting Organization was recorded in the International Register.

(7) *[Subsequent Designation Resulting from Conversion]*

- (a) Where the designation of a Contracting Organization has been recorded in the International Register and to the extent that such designation has been withdrawn, refused or has ceased to have effect under the law of that Organization, the holder of the international registration concerned may request the conversion of the designation of the said Contracting Organization into the designation of any Member State of that Organization which is party to the Protocol.
- (b) A request for conversion under subparagraph (a) shall indicate the elements referred to in paragraph (3)(a)(i) to (iii) and (v), together with:
 - (i) the Contracting Organization whose designation is to be converted, and
 - (ii) where the subsequent designation of a Contracting State resulting from conversion is for all the goods and services listed in respect of the designation of the Contracting Organization, that fact, or, where the designation of that Contracting State is for only part of the goods and services listed in the designation of that Contracting Organization, those goods and services.

- (8) *[Recording and Notification]* Where the International Bureau finds that the subsequent designation conforms to the applicable requirements, it shall record it in the International Register and shall notify accordingly the Office of the Contracting Party that has been designated in the subsequent designation and at the same time inform the holder and, if the subsequent designation was presented by an Office, that Office.

- (9) *[Refusal]* Rules 16 to 18~~ter~~ shall apply *mutatis mutandis*.
- (10) *[Subsequent Designation Not Considered as Such]* If the requirements of paragraph (2)(a) are not complied with, the subsequent designation shall not be considered as such and the International Bureau shall inform the sender accordingly.

Rule 25

Request for Recording

- (1) *[Presentation of the Request]*
- (a) A request for recording shall be presented to the International Bureau on the relevant official form where the request relates to any of the following:
- (i) a change in the ownership of the international registration in respect of all or some of the goods and services and all or some of the designated Contracting Parties;
 - (ii) a limitation of the list of goods and services in respect of all or some of the designated Contracting Parties;
 - (iii) a renunciation in respect of some of the designated Contracting Parties for all the goods and services;
 - (iv) a change in the name or address of the holder or, where the holder is a legal entity, an introduction of or a change in the indications concerning the legal nature of the holder and the State and, where applicable, the territorial unit within that State under the law of which the said legal entity has been organized;

- (v) cancellation of the international registration in respect of all the designated Contracting Parties for all or some of the goods and services;
 - (vi) a change in the name or address of the representative.
- (b) The request shall be presented by the holder or by the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder; however, the request for the recording of a change in ownership may be presented through the Office of the Contracting Party, or of one of the Contracting Parties, indicated in the said request in accordance with paragraph (2)(a)(iv).
- (c) [Deleted]
- (d) Where the request is presented by the holder, it shall be signed by the holder. Where it is presented by an Office, it shall be signed by that Office and, where the Office so requires, also by the holder. Where it is presented by an Office and that Office, without requiring that the holder also sign it, allows that the holder also sign it, the holder may do so.

(2) *[Contents of the Request]*

- (a) A request under paragraph (1)(a) shall, in addition to the requested recording, contain or indicate
- (i) the number of the international registration concerned,
 - (ii) the name of the holder or the name of the representative where the change relates to the name or address of the representative,

- (iii) in the case of a change in the ownership of the international registration, the name and address, given in accordance with the Administrative Instructions, and the electronic mail address of the natural person or legal entity mentioned in the request as the new holder of the international registration (hereinafter referred to as “the transferee”),
- (iv) in the case of a change in the ownership of the international registration, the Contracting Party or Parties in respect of which the transferee fulfills the conditions under Article 2 of the Protocol to be the holder of an international registration,
- (v) in the case of a change in the ownership of the international registration, where the address of the transferee given in accordance with item (iii) is not in the territory of the Contracting Party, or of one of the Contracting Parties, given in accordance with item (iv), and unless the transferee has indicated to be a national of a Contracting State or of a State member of a Contracting Organization, the address of the establishment, or the domicile, of the transferee in the Contracting Party, or in one of the Contracting Parties, in respect of which the transferee fulfills the conditions to be the holder of an international registration,
- (vi) in the case of a change in the ownership of the international registration that does not relate to all the goods and services and to all the designated Contracting Parties, the goods and services and the designated Contracting Parties to which the change in ownership relates,
- (vii) the amount of the fees being paid and the method of payment, or instructions to debit the required amount of fees to an account opened with the International Bureau, and the identification of the party effecting the payment or giving the instructions,

- (viii) the electronic mail address of the holder where this address was not indicated in the international application or in a previous request for recording,
 - (ix) the electronic mail address of the representative, if any, where this address was not indicated in the request for the recording of the appointment of the representative as such.
 - (b) The request for the recording of a change in the ownership of the international registration may also contain,
 - (i) where the transferee is a natural person, an indication of the State of which the transferee is a national;
 - (ii) where the transferee is a legal entity, indications concerning the legal nature of that legal entity and the State, and, where applicable, the territorial unit within that State, under the law of which the said legal entity has been organized.
 - (c) The request for recording of a change or a cancellation may also contain a request that it be recorded before, or after, the recording of another change or cancellation or a subsequent designation in respect of the international registration concerned or after the renewal of the international registration.
 - (d) The request for the recording of a limitation shall group the limited goods and services only under the corresponding numbers of the classes of the International Classification of Goods and Services appearing in the international registration or, where the limitation affects all the goods and services in one or more of those classes, indicate the classes to be deleted.
- (3) [Deleted]

- (4) *[Several Transferees]* Where the request for the recording of a change in the ownership of the international registration mentions several transferees, each of them must fulfill the conditions under Article 2 of the Madrid Protocol to be holder of the international registration.

Rule 26

Irregularities in Requests for Recording Under Rule 25

- (1) *[Irregular Request]* If a request under Rule 25(1)(a) does not comply with the applicable requirements, and subject to paragraph (3), the International Bureau shall notify that fact to the holder and, if the request was made by an Office, to that Office. For the purposes of this Rule, where the request is for the recording of a limitation, the International Bureau shall only examine whether the numbers of the classes indicated in the limitation appear in the international registration concerned.
- (2) *[Time Allowed to Remedy Irregularity]* The irregularity may be remedied within three months from the date of the notification of the irregularity by the International Bureau. If the irregularity is not remedied within three months from the date of the notification of the irregularity by the International Bureau, the request shall be considered abandoned, and the International Bureau shall notify accordingly and at the same time the holder and, if the request under Rule 25(1)(a) was presented by an Office, that Office, and refund any fees paid, after deduction of an amount corresponding to one-half of the relevant fees referred to in item 7 of the Schedule of Fees, to the party having paid those fees.
- (3) *[Requests Not Considered as Such]* If the requirements of Rule 25(1)(b) are not complied with, the request shall not be considered as such and the International Bureau shall inform the sender accordingly.

Rule 27**Recording and Notification with Respect to Rule 25; Declaration that a Change in Ownership or a Limitation Has No Effect****(1) [Recording and Notification]**

- (a) The International Bureau shall, provided that the request referred to in Rule 25(1)(a) is in order, promptly record the indications, the change or the cancellation in the International Register, shall notify accordingly the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties in which the recording has effect or, in the case of a cancellation, the Offices of all the designated Contracting Parties, and shall inform at the same time the holder and, if the request was presented by an Office, that Office. Where the recording relates to a change in ownership, the International Bureau shall also inform the former holder in the case of a total change in ownership and the holder of the part of the international registration which has been assigned or otherwise transferred in the case of a partial change in ownership. Where the request for the recording of a cancellation was presented by the holder or by an Office other than the Office of origin during the five-year period referred to in Article 6(3) of the Protocol, the International Bureau shall also inform the Office of origin.
- (b) The indications, the change or the cancellation shall be recorded as of the date of receipt by the International Bureau of a request complying with the applicable requirements, except that, where a request has been made in accordance with Rule 25(2)(c), it may be recorded as of a later date.
- (c) Notwithstanding subparagraph (b), where continued processing has been recorded under Rule 5*bis*, the change or cancellation shall be recorded in the International Register as of the date of expiry of the time limit specified in Rule 26(2), except that, where a request has been made in accordance with Rule 25(2)(c), it may be recorded as of a later date.

(2) *[Recording of Partial Change in Ownership]*

- (a) A change in ownership of the international registration in respect of only some of the goods and services or only some of the designated Contracting Parties shall be recorded in the International Register under the number of the international registration concerned by the partial change in ownership.
- (b) The part of the international registration for which a change in ownership has been recorded shall be deleted from the international registration concerned and recorded as a separate international registration.

(3) *[Deleted]*

(4) *[Declaration that a Change in Ownership Has No Effect]*

- (a) The Office of a designated Contracting Party which is notified, by the International Bureau, of a change in ownership affecting that Contracting Party may declare that the change in ownership has no effect in the said Contracting Party. The effect of such a declaration shall be that, with respect to the said Contracting Party, the international registration concerned shall remain in the name of the transferor.
- (b) The declaration referred to in subparagraph (a) shall indicate
 - (i) the reasons for which the change in ownership has no effect,
 - (ii) the corresponding essential provisions of the law, and
 - (iii) whether such declaration may be subject to review or appeal.
- (c) The declaration referred to in subparagraph (a) shall be sent to the International Bureau before the expiry of 18 months from the date on which the notification referred to in subparagraph (a) was sent to the Office concerned.

- (d) The International Bureau shall record in the International Register any declaration made in accordance with subparagraph (c) and, as the case may be, record as a separate international registration that part of the international registration which has been the subject of the said declaration, and shall notify accordingly the party (holder or Office) that presented the request for the recording of a change in ownership and the new holder.
- (e) Any final decision relating to a declaration made in accordance with subparagraph (c) shall be notified to the International Bureau which shall record it in the International Register and, as the case may be, modify the International Register accordingly, and shall notify accordingly the party (holder or Office) that presented the request for the recording of a change in ownership and the new holder.

(5) *[Declaration that a Limitation Has No Effect]*

- (a) The Office of a designated Contracting Party which is notified by the International Bureau of a limitation of the list of goods and services affecting that Contracting Party may declare that the limitation has no effect in the said Contracting Party. The effect of such a declaration shall be that, with respect to the said Contracting Party, the limitation shall not apply to the goods and services affected by the declaration.
- (b) The declaration referred to in subparagraph (a) shall indicate
 - (i) the reasons for which the limitation has no effect,
 - (ii) where the declaration does not affect all the goods and services to which the limitation relates, those which are affected by the declaration or those which are not affected by the declaration,
 - (iii) the corresponding essential provisions of the law, and
 - (iv) whether such declaration may be subject to review or appeal.

- (c) The declaration referred to in subparagraph (a) shall be sent to the International Bureau before the expiry of 18 months from the date on which the notification referred to in subparagraph (a) was sent to the Office concerned.
- (d) The International Bureau shall record in the International Register any declaration made in accordance with subparagraph (c) and shall notify accordingly the party (holder or Office) that presented the request to record the limitation.
- (e) Any final decision relating to a declaration made in accordance with subparagraph (c) shall be notified to the International Bureau which shall record it in the International Register and notify accordingly the party (holder or Office) that presented the request to record the limitation.

Rule 27bis

Division of an International Registration

(1) *[Request for the Division of an International Registration]*

- (a) A request by the holder for the division of an international registration for some only of the goods and services in respect of a designated Contracting Party shall be presented to the International Bureau on the relevant official form by the Office of that designated Contracting Party, once the latter is satisfied that the division whose recording is requested meets the requirements of its applicable law, including the requirements concerning fees.
- (b) The request shall indicate
 - (i) the Contracting Party of the Office presenting the request,
 - (ii) the name of the Office presenting the request,
 - (iii) the number of the international registration,

- (iv) the name of the holder,
 - (v) the names of the goods and services to be set apart, grouped in the appropriate classes of the International Classification of Goods and Services,
 - (vi) the amount of the fee being paid and the method of payment, or instructions to debit the required amount to an account opened with the International Bureau, and the identification of the party effecting the payment or giving the instructions.
 - (c) The request shall be signed by the Office presenting the request and, where the Office so requires, also by the holder.
 - (d) Any request presented under this paragraph may include or be accompanied by a statement sent in accordance with either Rule 18*bis* or 18*ter* for the goods and services listed in the request.
- (2) *[Fee]* The division of an international registration shall be subject to the payment of the fee specified in item 7.7 of the Schedule of Fees.
- (3) *[Irregular Request]*
- (a) If the request does not comply with the requirements specified in paragraph (1), the International Bureau shall invite the Office that presented the request to remedy the irregularity and at the same time inform the holder.
 - (b) If the amount of the fees received is less than the amount of the fees referred to in paragraph (2), the International Bureau shall notify accordingly the holder and at the same time inform the Office that presented the request.

- (c) If the irregularity is not remedied within three months from the date of the communication under subparagraph (a) or (b), the request shall be considered abandoned and the International Bureau shall notify accordingly the Office that presented the request, it shall inform at the same time the holder and refund any fee paid under paragraph (2), after the deduction of an amount corresponding to one-half of that fee.

(4) *[Recording and Notification]*

- (a) Where the request complies with the applicable requirements, the International Bureau shall record the division, create a divisional international registration in the International Register, notify accordingly the Office that presented the request and shall inform at the same time the holder.
- (b) The division of an international registration shall be recorded with the date of receipt by the International Bureau of the request or, where applicable, the date where the irregularity referred to in paragraph (3) was remedied.

(5) *[Request Not Considered as Such]* A request for the division of an international registration in respect of a designated Contracting Party that is not or is no longer designated for the classes of the International Classification of Goods and Services mentioned in the request will not be considered as such.

(6) *[Declaration that a Contracting Party Will Not Present Requests for Division]* A Contracting Party, the law of which does not provide for division of applications for the registration of a mark or registrations of a mark, may notify the Director General, before the date this Rule comes into force or the date on which the said Contracting Party becomes bound by the Protocol, that it will not present to the International Bureau the request referred to in paragraph (1). This declaration may be withdrawn at any time.

Rule 27ter**Merger of International Registrations**

- (1) *[Merger of International Registrations Resulting from the Recording of a Partial Change in Ownership]* Where the same natural person or legal entity has been recorded as the holder of two or more international registrations resulting from a partial change in ownership, the registrations shall be merged at the request of the said person or entity, made either direct or through the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder. The request shall be presented to the International Bureau on the relevant official form. The International Bureau shall record the merger, notify accordingly the Offices of the designated Contracting Party or Parties affected by the change and shall inform at the same time the holder and, if the request was presented by an Office, that Office.
- (2) *[Merger of International Registrations Resulting from the Recording of the Division of an International Registration]*
 - (a) An international registration resulting from division shall be merged into the international registration it was divided from at the request of the holder, presented through the Office that presented the request referred to in paragraph (1) of Rule 27bis, provided that the same natural person or legal entity is the recorded holder in both aforementioned international registrations and the Office concerned is satisfied that the request meets the requirements of its applicable law, including the requirements concerning fees. The request shall be presented to the International Bureau on the relevant official form. The International Bureau shall record the merger, notify accordingly the Office that presented the request and shall inform at the same time the holder.
 - (b) The Office of a Contracting Party, the law of which does not provide for the merger of registrations of a mark, may notify the Director General, before the date this Rule comes into force or the date on which the said Contracting Party becomes bound by the Protocol, that it will not present to the International Bureau the request referred to in subparagraph (a). This declaration may be withdrawn at any time.

Rule 28

Corrections in the International Register

- (1) *[Correction]* Where the International Bureau, acting *ex officio* or at the request of the holder or of an Office, considers that there is an error concerning an international registration in the International Register, it shall modify the Register accordingly.
- (2) *[Notification]* The International Bureau shall notify accordingly the holder and, at the same time, the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties in which the correction has effect. In addition, where the Office that has requested the correction is not the Office of a designated Contracting Party in which the correction has effect, the International Bureau shall also inform that Office.
- (3) *[Refusal Following a Correction]* Any Office referred to in paragraph (2) shall have the right to declare in a notification of provisional refusal addressed to the International Bureau that it considers that protection cannot, or can no longer, be granted to the international registration as corrected. Article 5 of the Protocol and Rules 16 to 18~~ter~~ shall apply *mutatis mutandis*, it being understood that the period allowed for sending the said notification shall be counted from the date of sending the notification of the correction to the Office concerned.
- (4) *[Time Limit for Correction]* Notwithstanding paragraph (1), an error which is attributable to an Office and the correction of which would affect the rights deriving from the international registration may be corrected only if a request for correction is received by the International Bureau within nine months from the date of publication of the entry in the International Register which is the subject of the correction.

Chapter 6

Renewals

Rule 29

Unofficial Notice of Expiry

The fact that the unofficial notice referred to in Article 7(3) of the Protocol is not received shall not constitute an excuse for failure to comply with any time limit under Rule 30.

Rule 30

Details Concerning Renewal

(1) *[Fees]*

- (a) The international registration shall be renewed upon payment, at the latest on the date on which the renewal of the international registration is due, of
 - (i) the basic fee,
 - (ii) where applicable, the supplementary fee, and,
 - (iii) the complementary fee or individual fee, as the case may be, for each designated Contracting Party for which no statement of refusal under Rule 18~~ter~~ or invalidation, in respect of all the goods and services concerned, is recorded in the International Register, as specified or referred to in item 6 of the Schedule of Fees.

However, such payment may be made within six months from the date on which the renewal of the international registration is due, provided that the surcharge specified in item 6.5 of the Schedule of Fees is paid at the same time.

- (b) If any payment made for the purposes of renewal is received by the International Bureau earlier than six months before the date on which the renewal of the international registration is due, it shall be considered as having been received six months before the date on which renewal is due.
- (c) Without prejudice to paragraph (2), where a statement under Rule 18~~ter~~(2) or (4) has been recorded in the International Register for a Contracting Party in respect of which payment of individual fee is due under subparagraph (a)(iii), the amount of that individual fee shall be established taking into account the goods and services included in the said statement only.

(2) *[Further Details]*

- (a) Where the holder does not wish to renew the international registration in respect of a designated Contracting Party for which no statement of refusal under Rule 18~~ter~~, in respect of all the goods and services concerned, is recorded in the International Register, payment of the required fees shall be accompanied by a statement by the holder that the renewal of the international registration is not to be recorded in the International Register in respect of that Contracting Party.
- (b) Where the holder wishes to renew the international registration in respect of a designated Contracting Party notwithstanding the fact that a statement of refusal under Rule 18~~ter~~ is recorded in the International Register for that Contracting Party in respect of all the goods and services concerned, payment of the required fees, including the complementary fee or individual fee, as the case may be, for that Contracting Party, shall be accompanied by a statement by the holder that the renewal of the international registration is to be recorded in the International Register in respect of that Contracting Party for all the goods and services concerned.

- (c) The international registration shall not be renewed in respect of any designated Contracting Party in respect of which an invalidation has been recorded for all goods and services under Rule 19(2) or in respect of which a renunciation has been recorded under Rule 27(1)(a). The international registration shall not be renewed in respect of any designated Contracting Party for those goods and services in respect of which an invalidation of the effects of the international registration in that Contracting Party has been recorded under Rule 19(2) or in respect of which a limitation has been recorded under Rule 27(1)(a).
- (d) [Deleted]
- (e) The fact that the international registration is not renewed in respect of all of the designated Contracting Parties shall not be considered to constitute a change for the purposes of Article 7(2) of the Protocol.

(3) *[Insufficient Fees]*

- (a) If the amount of the fees received is less than the amount of the fees required for renewal, the International Bureau shall promptly notify at the same time both the holder and the representative, if any, accordingly. The notification shall specify the missing amount.
- (b) If the amount of the fees received is, on the expiry of the period of six months referred to in paragraph (1)(a), less than the amount required under paragraph (1), the International Bureau shall not, subject to subparagraph (c), record the renewal, and shall reimburse the amount received to the party having paid it and notify accordingly the holder and the representative, if any.

- (c) If the notification referred to in subparagraph (a) was sent during the three months preceding the expiry of the period of six months referred to in paragraph (1)(a) and if the amount of the fees received is, on the expiry of that period, less than the amount required under paragraph (1) but is at least 70% of that amount, the International Bureau shall proceed as provided in Rule 31(1) and (3). If the amount required is not fully paid within three months from the said notification, the International Bureau shall cancel the renewal, notify accordingly the holder, the representative, if any, and the Offices which had been notified of the renewal, and reimburse the amount received to the party having paid it.
- (4) *[Period for Which Renewal Fees Are Paid]* The fees required for each renewal shall be paid for ten years.

Rule 31

Recording of the Renewal; Notification and Certificate

- (1) *[Recording and Effective Date of the Renewal]* Renewal shall be recorded in the International Register with the date on which renewal was due, even if the fees required for renewal are paid within the period of grace referred to in Article 7(4) of the Protocol.
- (2) *[Renewal Date in the Case of Subsequent Designations]* The effective date of the renewal shall be the same for all designations contained in the international registration, irrespective of the date on which such designations were recorded in the International Register.
- (3) *[Notification and Certificate]* The International Bureau shall notify the Offices of the designated Contracting Parties concerned of the renewal and shall send a certificate to the holder.
- (4) *[Notification in Case of Non-Renewal]*
 - (a) Where an international registration is not renewed, the International Bureau shall notify accordingly the holder, the representative, if any, and the Offices of all of the Contracting Parties designated in that international registration.

- (b) Where an international registration is not renewed in respect of a designated Contracting Party, the International Bureau shall notify the holder, the representative, if any, and the Office of that Contracting Party accordingly.

Chapter 7

Gazette and Data Base

Rule 32

Gazette

(1) [Information Concerning International Registrations]

- (a) The International Bureau shall publish in the Gazette relevant data concerning
 - (i) international registrations effected under Rule 14;
 - (ii) information communicated under Rule 16(1);
 - (iii) provisional refusals recorded under Rule 17(4), with an indication as to whether the refusal relates to all the goods and services or only some of them but without an indication of the goods and services concerned and without the grounds for refusal, and statements and information recorded under Rules 18*bis*(2) and 18*ter*(5);
 - (iv) renewals recorded under Rule 31(1);
 - (v) subsequent designations recorded under Rule 24(8);
 - (vi) continuation of effects of international registrations under Rule 39;
 - (vii) recordings under Rule 27;

- (viii) cancellations effected under Rule 22(2) or recorded under Rule 27(1) or Rule 34(3)(d);
 - (viii**bis**) division recorded under Rule 27**bis**(4) and merger recorded under Rule 27**ter**.
 - (ix) corrections effected under Rule 28;
 - (x) invalidations recorded under Rule 19(2);
 - (xi) information recorded under Rules 20, 20**bis**, 21, 21**bis**, 22(2)(a), 23 and 27(4) and (5);
 - (xii) international registrations which have not been renewed;
 - (xiii) recordings of the appointment of the holder's representative communicated under Rule 3(2)(b) and cancellations at the request of the holder or the holder's representative under Rule 3(6)(a).
- (b) The representation of the mark shall be published as it was furnished in the international application. Where the applicant has made the declaration referred to in Rule 9(4)(a)(vi), the publication shall indicate that fact.
- (c) [Deleted]
- (2) *[Information Concerning Particular Requirements and Certain Declarations of Contracting Parties]* The International Bureau shall publish in the Gazette
- (i) any notification made under Rules 7, 17(7), 20**bis**(6), 27**bis**(6), 27**ter**(2)(b) or 40(6) and (8) and any declaration made under Rule 17(5)(d) or (e);
 - (ii) any declarations made under Article 5(2)(b) or Article 5(2)(b) and (c), first sentence, of the Protocol;

- (iii) any declarations made under Article 8(7) of the Protocol;
 - (iv) any notification made under Rule 34(2)(b) or (3)(a);
 - (v) a list of the days on which the International Bureau is not scheduled to be open to the public during the current and the following calendar year.
- (3) *[Publications on the Website]* The International Bureau shall effect the publications under paragraphs (1) and (2) on the website of the World Intellectual Property Organization.

Rule 33

Electronic Data Base

- (1) *[Contents of Data Base]* The data which are both recorded in the International Register and published in the Gazette under Rule 32 shall be entered in an electronic data base.
- (2) *[Data Concerning Pending International Applications and Subsequent Designations]* If an international application or a designation under Rule 24 is not recorded in the International Register within three working days following the receipt by the International Bureau of the international application or designation, the International Bureau shall enter in the electronic data base, notwithstanding any irregularities that may exist in the international application or designation as received, all the data contained in the international application or designation.
- (3) *[Access to Electronic Data Base]* The electronic data base shall be made accessible to the Offices of the Contracting Parties and, against payment of the prescribed fee, if any, to the public, by on-line access and through other appropriate means determined by the International Bureau. The cost of accessing shall be borne by the user. Data entered under paragraph (2) shall be accompanied by a warning to the effect that the International Bureau has not yet made a decision on the international application or on the designation under Rule 24.

Chapter 8

Fees

Rule 34

Amounts and Payment of Fees

- (1) *[Amounts of Fees]* The amounts of fees due under the Protocol or these Regulations, other than individual fees, are specified in the Schedule of Fees that is annexed to these Regulations and forms an integral part thereof.
- (2) *[Payments]*
 - (a) The fees indicated in the Schedule of Fees may be paid to the International Bureau by the applicant or the holder, or, where the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder accepts to collect and forward such fees, and the applicant or the holder so wishes, by that Office.
 - (b) Any Contracting Party whose Office accepts to collect and forward fees shall notify that fact to the Director General.
- (3) *[Individual Fee Payable in Two Parts]*
 - (a) A Contracting Party that makes or has made a declaration under Article 8(7) of the Protocol may notify the Director General that the individual fee to be paid in respect of a designation of that Contracting Party comprises two parts, the first part to be paid at the time of filing the international application or the subsequent designation of that Contracting Party and the second part to be paid at a later date which is determined in accordance with the law of that Contracting Party.
 - (b) Where subparagraph (a) applies, the references in items 2 and 5 of the Schedule of Fees to an individual fee shall be construed as references to the first part of the individual fee.

- (c) Where subparagraph (a) applies, the Office of the designated Contracting Party concerned shall notify the International Bureau when the payment of the second part of the individual fee becomes due. The notification shall indicate
 - (i) the number of the international registration concerned,
 - (ii) the name of the holder,
 - (iii) the date by which the second part of the individual fee must be paid,
 - (iv) where the amount of the second part of the individual fee is dependent on the number of classes of goods and services for which the mark is protected in the designated Contracting Party concerned, the number of such classes.
 - (d) The International Bureau shall transmit the notification to the holder. Where the second part of the individual fee is paid within the applicable period, the International Bureau shall record the payment in the International Register and notify the Office of the Contracting Party concerned accordingly. Where the second part of the individual fee is not paid within the applicable period, the International Bureau shall notify the Office of the Contracting Party concerned, cancel the international registration in the International Register with respect to the Contracting Party concerned and notify the holder accordingly.
- (4) *[Modes of Payment of Fees to the International Bureau]* Fees shall be paid to the International Bureau as specified in the Administrative Instructions.

- (5) *[Indications Accompanying the Payment]* At the time of the payment of any fee to the International Bureau, an indication must be given,
- (i) before international registration, of the name of the applicant, the mark concerned and the purpose of the payment;
 - (ii) after international registration, of the name of the holder, the number of the international registration concerned and the purpose of the payment.
- (6) *[Date of Payment]*
- (a) Subject to Rule 30(1)(b) and to subparagraph (b), any fee shall be considered to have been paid to the International Bureau on the day on which the International Bureau receives the required amount.
 - (b) Where the required amount is available in an account opened with the International Bureau and that Bureau has received instructions from the holder of the account to debit it, the fee shall be considered to have been paid to the International Bureau on the day on which the International Bureau receives an international application, a subsequent designation, an instruction to debit the second part of an individual fee, a request for the recording of a change or an instruction to renew an international registration.
- (7) *[Change in the Amount of the Fees]*
- (a) Where the amount of the fees payable in respect of the filing of an international application is changed between, on the one hand, the date on which the request to present the international application to the International Bureau is received by the Office of origin and, on the other hand, the date of the receipt of the international application by the International Bureau, the fee that was valid on the first date shall be applicable.

- (b) Where a designation under Rule 24 is presented by the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder and the amount of the fees payable in respect of that designation is changed between, on the one hand, the date of receipt, by the Office, of the request by the holder to present the said designation and, on the other hand, the date on which the designation is received by the International Bureau, the fee that was valid on the first date shall be applicable.
- (c) Where paragraph (3)(a) applies, the amount of the second part of the individual fee which is valid on the later date referred to in that paragraph shall be applicable.
- (d) Where the amount of the fees payable in respect of the renewal of an international registration is changed between the date of payment and the due date of the renewal, the fee that was valid on the date of payment, or on the date considered to be the date of payment under Rule 30(1)(b), shall be applicable. Where the payment is made after the due date, the fee that was valid on the due date shall be applicable.
- (e) Where the amount of any fee other than the fees referred to in subparagraphs (a), (b), (c) and (d) is changed, the amount valid on the date on which the fee was received by the International Bureau shall be applicable.

Rule 35

Currency of Payments

- (1) *[Obligation to Use Swiss Currency]* All payments due under these Regulations shall be made to the International Bureau in Swiss currency irrespective of the fact that, where the fees are paid by an Office, that Office may have collected those fees in another currency.

(2) *[Establishment of the Amount of Individual Fees in Swiss Currency]*

- (a) Where a Contracting Party makes a declaration under Article 8(7)(a) of the Protocol that it wants to receive an individual fee, the amount of the individual fee indicated to the International Bureau shall be expressed in the currency used by its Office.
- (b) Where the fee is indicated in the declaration referred to in subparagraph (a) in a currency other than Swiss currency, the Director General shall, after consultation with the Office of the Contracting Party concerned, establish the amount of the individual fee in Swiss currency on the basis of the official exchange rate of the United Nations.
- (c) Where, for more than three consecutive months, the official exchange rate of the United Nations between the Swiss currency and the other currency in which the amount of an individual fee has been indicated by a Contracting Party is higher by at least 5% than the last exchange rate applied to establish the amount of the individual fee in Swiss currency, the Office of that Contracting Party may ask the Director General to establish a new amount of the individual fee in Swiss currency according to the official exchange rate of the United Nations prevailing on the day preceding the day on which the request is made. The Director General shall proceed accordingly. The new amount shall be applicable as from a date which shall be fixed by the Director General, provided that such date is between one and two months after the date of the publication of the said amount in the Gazette.

- (d) Where, for more than three consecutive months, the official exchange rate of the United Nations between the Swiss currency and the other currency in which the amount of an individual fee has been indicated by a Contracting Party is lower by at least 5% than the last exchange rate applied to establish the amount of the individual fee in Swiss currency, the Director General shall establish a new amount of the individual fee in Swiss currency according to the current official exchange rate of the United Nations. The new amount shall be applicable as from a date which shall be fixed by the Director General, provided that such date is between one and two months after the date of the publication of the said amount in the Gazette.
- (e) Where the conditions specified in subparagraph (c), above, are met, the International Bureau shall inform the Office of the Contracting Party concerned accordingly.

Rule 36

Exemption From Fees

Recording of the following shall be exempt from fees:

- (i) the appointment of a representative, any change concerning a representative and the cancellation of the recording of a representative,
- (ii) any change concerning the telephone number, address for correspondence, electronic mail address and any other means of communication with the applicant, holder, or representative, as specified in the Administrative Instructions,
- (iii) the cancellation of the international registration,
- (iv) any renunciation under Rule 25(1)(a)(iii),
- (v) any limitation effected in the international application itself under Rule 9(4)(a)(xiii) or in a subsequent designation under Rule 24(3)(a)(iv),

- (vi) any request by an Office under Article 6(4), first sentence, of the Protocol,
- (vii) the existence of a judicial proceeding or of a final decision affecting the basic application, or the registration resulting therefrom, or the basic registration,
- (viii) any refusal under Rule 17, Rule 24(9) or Rule 28(3), any statement under Rules 18*bis* or 18*ter* or any declaration under Rule 20*bis*(5) or Rule 27(4) or (5),
- (ix) the invalidation of the international registration,
- (x) information communicated under Rule 20,
- (xi) any notification under Rule 21 or Rule 23,
- (xii) any correction in the International Register.

Rule 37

Distribution of Supplementary Fees and Complementary Fees

- (1) The coefficient referred to in Article 8(5) and (6) of the Protocol shall be as follows:

for Contracting Parties which examine only for absolute grounds of refusal-----two

for Contracting Parties which also examine for prior rights:

(a) following opposition by third parties-----three

(b) *ex officio* ----- four

- (2) Coefficient four shall also be applied to Contracting Parties which carry out *ex officio* searches for prior rights with an indication of the most significant prior rights.

Rule 38**Crediting of Individual Fees to the Accounts of the Contracting Parties Concerned**

Any individual fee paid to the International Bureau in respect of a Contracting Party having made a declaration under Article 8(7)(a) of the Protocol shall be credited to the account of that Contracting Party with the International Bureau within the month following the month in the course of which the recording of the international registration, subsequent designation or renewal for which that fee has been paid was effected or the payment of the second part of the individual fee was recorded.

Chapter 9***Miscellaneous*****Rule 39****Continuation of Effects of International Registrations in Certain Successor States**

- (1) Where any State ("the successor State") whose territory was, before the independence of that State, part of the territory of a Contracting Party ("the predecessor Contracting Party") has deposited with the Director General a declaration of continuation the effect of which is that the Protocol is applied by the successor State, the effects in the successor State of any international registration with a territorial extension to the predecessor Contracting Party which is effective from a date prior to the date fixed under paragraph (2) shall be subject to
 - (i) the filing with the International Bureau, within six months from the date of a notice addressed for that purpose by the International Bureau to the holder of the international registration concerned, of a request that such international registration continue its effects in the successor State, and

- (ii) the payment to the International Bureau, within the same time limit, of the fee specified in item 10.1 of the Schedule of Fees for the International Bureau, and of the fee specified in item 10.2 of the Schedule of Fees, which shall be transferred by the International Bureau to the successor State.
- (2) The date referred to in paragraph (1) shall be the date notified by the successor State to the International Bureau for the purposes of this Rule, provided that such date may not be earlier than the date of independence of the successor State.
- (3) The International Bureau shall, upon receipt of the request and the fees referred to in paragraph (1), notify the Office of the successor State and make the corresponding recording in the International Register.
- (4) With respect to any international registration concerning which the Office of the successor State has received a notification under paragraph (3), that Office may only refuse protection if the applicable time limit referred to in Article 5(2)(a), (b) or (c) of the Protocol has not expired with respect to the territorial extension to the predecessor Contracting Party and if the notification of refusal is received by the International Bureau within that time limit.
- (5) This Rule shall not apply to the Russian Federation, nor to a State which has deposited with the Director General a declaration according to which it continues the legal personality of a Contracting Party.

Rule 40

Entry into Force; Transitional Provisions

- (1) *[Entry into Force]* These Regulations shall enter into force on February 1, 2020, and shall, as of that date, replace the Common Regulations under the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks and the Protocol Relating to that Agreement as in force on January 31, 2020 (hereinafter referred to as “the Common Regulations”).

(2) *[General Transitional Provisions]*

- (a) Notwithstanding paragraph (1),
 - (i) an international application the request for presentation to the International Bureau of which was received by the Office of origin before February 1, 2020, shall, to the extent that it conforms to the requirements of the Common Regulations, be deemed to conform to the applicable requirements for the purposes of Rule 14;
 - (ii) a subsequent designation or a request for recording presented to the International Bureau before February 1, 2020, shall, to the extent that it conforms to the requirements of the Common Regulations, be deemed to conform to the applicable requirements for the purposes of Rules *5bis*, *20bis*(3), 24(8), 27, *27bis* or *27ter*;
 - (iii) an international application, a subsequent designation or a request for recording that, before February 1, 2020, has been the subject of any action by the International Bureau under Rules 11, 12, 13, *20bis*(2), 24(5), 26 or *27bis*(3)(a) of the Common Regulations, shall continue to be processed by the International Bureau under the said Rules; the date of the resulting international registration or recording in the International Register shall be governed by Rules 15, *20bis*(3)(b), 24(6), 27(1)(b) and (c) or *27bis*(4)(b) of the Common Regulations;

- (iv) a notification under Articles *4bis*(2), 5(1) and (2), 5(6) or 6(4) of the Protocol or under Rules *21bis*, 23 or 34(3)(c) of the Common Regulations sent to the International Bureau before February 1, 2020, shall, to the extent that it conforms to the requirements of the Common Regulations, be deemed to conform to the applicable requirements for the purposes of Rules 17(4), 19(2), 21(2), *21bis*(4), 22(2), 23(2) or 34(3)(d);
 - (v) a communication, a statement, declaration or final decision under Rules 16, *18bis*, *18ter*, 20, *20bis*(5), *23bis* or 27(4) or (5) of the Common Regulations sent to the International Bureau before February 1, 2020, shall, to the extent that it conforms to the requirements of the Common Regulations, be deemed to conform to the applicable requirements for the purposes of Rules 16(2), *18bis*(2), *18ter*(5), 20(3), *20bis*(5)(d), *23bis*(3), 27(4)(d) and (e) or (5)(d) and (e).
 - (b) For the purposes of Rule 34(7), the fees valid at any date before February 1, 2020, shall be the fees prescribed by Rule 34(1) of the Common Regulations.
 - (c) A notification under Rules 6(2)(iii), 7(2), 17(5)(d), *20bis*(6), *27bis*(6), *27ter*(2)(b), 34(3)(a) or 40(6) of the Common Regulations sent by the Office of a Contracting Party to the International Bureau before February 1, 2020, shall continue to have effects in accordance with Rules 6(2)(iii), 7(2), 17(5)(d), *20bis*(6), *27bis*(6), *27ter*(2)(b), 34(3)(a) or 40(6).
 - (d) [Deleted]
- (3) [Deleted]

(4) *[Transitional Provisions Concerning Languages]*

- (a) Rule 6 of the Common Regulations as in force before April 1, 2004, shall continue to apply to any international application filed before that date and to any international application governed exclusively by the Agreement filed between that date and August 31, 2008, inclusively, as defined in Rule 1(viii) of the Common Regulations, to any communication relating thereto and to any communication, recording in the International Register or publication in the Gazette relating to the international registration resulting therefrom, unless
 - (i) the international registration has been the subject of a subsequent designation under the Protocol in accordance with Rule 24(1)(c) of the Common Regulations between April 1, 2004, and August 31, 2008; or
 - (ii) the international registration is the subject of a subsequent designation on or after September 1, 2008; and
 - (iii) the subsequent designation is recorded in the International Register.
- (b) For the purposes of this paragraph, an international application is deemed to be filed on the date on which the request to present the international application to the International Bureau is received, or deemed to have been received under Rule 11(1)(a) or (c) of the Common Regulations, by the Office of origin, and an international registration is deemed to be the subject of a subsequent designation on the date on which the subsequent designation is presented to the International Bureau, if it is presented directly by the holder, or on the date on which the request for presentation of the subsequent designation is filed with the Office of the Contracting Party of the holder if it is presented through the latter.

(5) *[Deleted]*

- (6) *[Incompatibility with National or Regional Laws]* If, on the date this Rule comes into force or the date on which a Contracting Party becomes bound by the Protocol, paragraph (1) of Rule 27*bis* or paragraph (2)(a) of Rule 27*ter* are not compatible with the national or regional law of that Contracting Party, the paragraph or paragraphs concerned, as the case may be, shall not apply in respect of this Contracting Party, for as long as it or they continue not to be compatible with that law, provided that the said Contracting Party notifies the International Bureau accordingly before the date this Rule comes into force or the date on which the said Contracting Party becomes bound by the Protocol. This notification may be withdrawn at any time.
- (7) *[Transitional Provision Relating to Partial Replacement]* No Office shall be obliged to apply Rule 21(3)(d), second sentence, before February 1, 2025.
- (8) *[Transitional Provision Relating to Rules 17(2)(v) and (vii) and (3) and 18(1)(e)]* Contracting Parties may continue to apply Rules 17(2)(v) and (vii) and (3) and 18(1)(e), as in force on November 1, 2021, until February 1, 2025, or until a later date, provided the Contracting Party concerned sends a notification to the International Bureau before February 1, 2025, or before the date on which this Contracting Party becomes bound by the Protocol, whichever occurs later. The Contracting Party may withdraw the said notification at any time thereafter⁹.

⁹ In adopting this provision, the Assembly of the Madrid Union understood that Contracting Parties are not required to specify in the notification the date on which they will apply Rules 17(2)(v) and (vii) and 18(1)(e), as in force on November 1, 2023.

Rule 41

Administrative Instructions

- (1) *[Establishment of Administrative Instructions; Matters Governed by Them]*
 - (a) The Director General shall establish Administrative Instructions. The Director General may modify them. Before establishing or modifying the Administrative Instructions, the Director General shall consult the Offices which have a direct interest in the proposed Administrative Instructions or their proposed modification.
 - (b) The Administrative Instructions shall deal with matters in respect of which these Regulations expressly refer to such Instructions and with details in respect of the application of these Regulations.
- (2) *[Control by the Assembly]* The Assembly may invite the Director General to modify any provision of the Administrative Instructions, and the Director General shall proceed accordingly.
- (3) *[Publication and Effective Date]*
 - (a) The Administrative Instructions and any modification thereof shall be published in the Gazette.
 - (b) Each publication shall specify the date on which the published provisions become effective. The dates may be different for different provisions, provided that no provision may be declared effective prior to its publication in the Gazette.
- (4) *[Conflict with the Protocol or These Regulations]* In the case of conflict between, on the one hand, any provision of the Administrative Instructions and, on the other hand any provision of the Protocol or these Regulations, the latter shall prevail.

Administrative Instructions for the Application of the Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks

as in force on February 1, 2023

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Part One
Definitions

Section 1
Abbreviated Expressions

- (a) For the purposes of these Administrative Instructions:
 - (i) “Regulations” means the Regulations under the Protocol Relating to the Madrid Agreement Concerning the International Registration of Marks;
 - (ii) “Rule” means a Rule of the Regulations.
- (b) For the purposes of these Administrative Instructions, an expression which is referred to in Rule 1 has the same meaning as in the Regulations.

Part Two
Forms

Section 2
Prescribed Forms

For any procedure for which the Regulations prescribe the use of a form, the International Bureau shall establish such a form.

Section 3

Optional Forms

In respect of procedures under the Regulations other than those referred to in Section 2, the International Bureau may establish optional forms.

Section 4

Publication and Availability of Forms

The International Bureau shall publish and make available all prescribed and optional forms, as referred to in Sections 2 and 3, on the website of the World Intellectual Property Organization.

Section 5

[Deleted]

Part Three

Communications with the International Bureau; Signature; Representation of the Mark

Section 6

Communication in Writing

- (a) Subject to Section 11(a), communications addressed to the International Bureau shall be effected in writing by typewriter or other machine and shall be signed.
- (b) [Deleted]

Section 7

Signature

- (a) A signature shall be handwritten, printed, typed or stamped. As regards the electronic communications referred to in Section 11(a)(i), a signature may be replaced by a mode of identification agreed upon between the International Bureau and the Office concerned. With respect to the electronic communications referred to in Section 11(a)(ii), a signature may be replaced by a mode of identification to be determined by the International Bureau.
- (b) Where there are two or more applicants, holders, new holders or licensees, the signature of one of them shall be sufficient, provided the person signing declare to have the authority to do so under the applicable law.

Section 8

[Deleted]

Section 9

[Deleted]

Section 10

[Deleted]

Section 11

Electronic Communications; Acknowledgement and Date of Receipt of Electronic Transmission by the International Bureau

- (a) (i) Communications between an Office and the International Bureau, including the presentation of the international application, shall be by electronic means in the way agreed upon between the International Bureau and the Office concerned.
- (ii) Communications between the International Bureau and applicants and holders shall take place by electronic means, in a manner and format to be determined by the International Bureau, the particulars of which shall be published on the website of the World Intellectual Property Organization.
- (b) The International Bureau shall promptly and by electronic transmission inform the originator of an electronic transmission of the receipt of that transmission, and, where the electronic transmission received is incomplete or otherwise unusable, also of that fact, provided that the originator can be identified and can be reached.
- (c) Where, because of the time difference between the place from where the communication is sent and Geneva, the date on which the sending started is different from the date of receipt by the International Bureau of the complete communication, the earlier of the two dates shall be considered as the date of receipt by the International Bureau.

Section 11*bis***Representation of the Mark**

- (a) A visual representation of the mark shall not exceed a maximum size of 20 by 20 centimeters and shall be furnished in or with the international application.
- (b) Alternatively, the representation of the mark shall be furnished with the international application as a single digital file, and where it consists of a
 - (i) visual representation, in JPEG, PNG or TIFF format, in accordance with the Recommendations for the Electronic Management of the Figurative Elements of Trademarks, WIPO Standard ST.67, adopted on May 4, 2012; or
 - (ii) sound recording, in MP3 or WAV format, not exceeding 5 MB in size, in accordance with the Recommendations for the Electronic Management of Sound Marks, WIPO Standard ST.68, adopted on March 24, 2016; or
 - (iii) motion or multimedia recording, in MP4 format, with AVC/H.264 or MPEG-2/H.262 codecs, not exceeding 20 MB in size, in accordance with the Recommendations for the Electronic Management of Motion and Multimedia Marks, WIPO Standard ST.69, adopted on December 4, 2020.

Part Four
Requirements Concerning Names and Addresses

Section 12
Names and Addresses

- (a) In the case of a natural person, the name to be indicated is the family or principal name and the given or secondary name(s) of the natural person.
- (b) In the case of a legal entity, the name to be indicated is the full official designation of the legal entity.
- (c) In the case of a name in characters other than Latin characters, the indication of that name shall consist of a transliteration into Latin characters which shall follow the phonetics of the language of the international application. In the case of a legal entity whose name is in characters other than Latin characters, the said transliteration may be replaced by a translation into the language of the international application.
- (d) An address and an electronic mail address shall be given in such a way as to satisfy the customary requirements for prompt postal or electronic delivery, as the case may be. An address shall consist, at least, of all the relevant administrative units up to, and including, the house number, if any. In addition, a telephone number, as well as a different address and an additional electronic mail address for correspondence may be indicated.

Section 13
Address for Correspondence

Where there are two or more applicants, new holders or licensees with different addresses, one address and one electronic mail address for correspondence may be indicated. Where no such addresses are indicated, the address and electronic mail address of the person named first shall be treated as the addresses for correspondence.

Part Five

Notification of Provisional Refusals

Section 14

[Deleted]

Section 15

Contents of a Notification of Provisional Refusal Based on an Opposition

- (a) A notification of provisional refusal based on an opposition shall be confined to the elements specified in Rule 17(2) and (3). The indication of the grounds on which the provisional refusal is based, in accordance with Rule 17(2)(iv), shall, in addition to stating that the refusal is based on an opposition, state concisely what are the grounds of the opposition (for example, conflict with an earlier mark or other right, lack of distinctive character). Where the opposition is based on a conflict with an earlier right other than a mark which is registered or is the subject of an application for registration, that right, and preferably the owner of that right, shall be identified as concisely as possible. The notification shall not be accompanied by memoranda or evidence.
- (b) [Deleted]

Part Six
Numbering of International Registrations

Section 16
Numbering Following Division or Partial Change in Ownership

- (a) The separate international registration resulting from the recording of partial change in ownership or division shall bear the number of the international registration of which a part has changed in ownership or been divided, followed by a capital letter.
- (b) [Deleted]

Section 17
Numbering Following Merger of International Registrations

The international registration resulting from the merger of international registrations in accordance with Rule 27*ter* shall bear the number of the international registration of which a part had changed in ownership or been divided, followed, where applicable, by a capital letter.

Section 18
Numbering Following Declaration that a Change in Ownership Has No Effect

The separate international registration which is recorded in the International Register in accordance with Rule 27(4)(e) shall bear the number of the registration of which a part has been assigned or otherwise transferred, together with a capital letter.

Part Seven
Payment of Fees

Section 19
Modes of Payment

Fees shall be paid to the International Bureau

- (i) by debit to a current account with the International Bureau; or,
- (ii) by payment into the Swiss postal account or to any of the specified bank accounts of the International Bureau; or,
- (iii) by credit card, where, in the context of an electronic communication envisaged in Section 11, an electronic interface for online payment has been made available by the International Bureau.

Schedule of Fees

as in force on February 1, 2023

Schedule of Fees

Swiss francs

1. [Deleted]

2. International application

The following fees shall be payable and shall cover 10 years:

2.1.	Basic fee (Article 8(2)(i) of the Protocol)*	
2.1.1.	where no representation of the mark is in color	653
2.1.2.	where any representation of the mark is in color	903
2.2.	Supplementary fee for each class of goods and services beyond three classes, except if only Contracting Parties in respect of which individual fees (see 2.4, below) are payable are designated (Article 8(2)(ii) and (7)(a)(i) of the Protocol)	100

* For international applications filed by applicants whose country of origin is a Least Developed Country, in accordance with the list established by the United Nations, the basic fee is reduced to 10% of the prescribed amount (rounded to the nearest full figure). In such case, the basic fee will amount to 65 Swiss francs (where no representation of the mark is in color) or to 90 Swiss francs (where any representation of the mark is in color).

Schedule of Fees

Swiss francs

- | | | |
|------|--|---|
| 2.3. | Complementary fee for each designated Contracting Party, except if the designated Contracting Party is a Contracting Party in respect of which an individual fee (see 2.4 below) is payable (Article 8(2)(iii) and (7)(a)(ii) of the Protocol) | 100 |
| 2.4. | Individual fee for each designated Contracting Party in respect of which an individual fee (rather than a complementary fee) is payable, except where the designated Contracting Party and the Contracting Party of the Office of origin are both States bound also by the Agreement, in which case, a complementary fee is payable in respect of such a designated Contracting Party (Articles 8(7)(a) and 9sexies(1)(b) of the Protocol) | the amount of the individual fee is fixed by each Contracting Party concerned |

3. *[Deleted]*

4. *Irregularities with respect to the classification of goods and services*

The following fees shall be payable (Rule 12(1)(b)):

- | | | |
|-----|---|------------------------------------|
| 4.1 | Where the goods and services are not grouped in classes | 77 plus 4 per term in excess of 20 |
|-----|---|------------------------------------|

*Schedule of Fees**Swiss francs*

- 4.2 Where the classification, as appearing in the application, of one or more terms is incorrect 20 plus 4 per incorrectly classified term

provided that, where the total amount due under this item in respect of an international application is less than 150 Swiss francs, no fees shall be payable.

5. *Designation subsequent to international registration*

The following fees shall be payable and shall cover the period between the effective date of the designation and the expiry of the then current term of the international registration (Article 3ter(2) of the Protocol):

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----|
| 5.1 | Basic fee | 300 |
| 5.2 | Complementary fee for each designated Contracting Party indicated in the same request where an individual fee is not payable in respect of such designated Contracting Party (see 5.3, below) | 100 |

*Schedule of Fees**Swiss francs*

- | | | |
|-----|---|---|
| 5.3 | Individual fee for each designated Contracting Party in respect of which an individual fee (rather than a complementary fee) is payable, except where the designated Contracting Party and the Contracting Party of the holder are both States bound also by the Agreement, in which case, a complementary fee is payable in respect of such a designated Contracting Party (Articles 8(7)(a) and 9 <i>sexies</i> (1)(b) of the Protocol) | the amount of the individual fee is fixed by each Contracting Party concerned |
|-----|---|---|

6. *Renewal*

The following fees shall be payable and shall cover 10 years (Article 7(1) of the Protocol):

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----|
| 6.1 | Basic fee | 653 |
| 6.2 | Supplementary fee, except if the renewal is made only for designated Contracting Parties in respect of which individual fees are payable (see 6.4, below) | 100 |
| 6.3 | Complementary fee for each designated Contracting Party in respect of which an individual fee is not payable (see 6.4, below) | 100 |

*Schedule of Fees**Swiss francs*

- | | | |
|-----|---|---|
| 6.4 | Individual fee for each designated Contracting Party in respect of which an individual fee (rather than a complementary fee) is payable, except where the designated Contracting Party and the Contracting Party of the holder are both States bound also by the Agreement, in which case, a complementary fee is payable in respect of such a Contracting Party (Articles 8(7)(a) and 9sexies(1)(b) of the Protocol) | the amount of the individual fee is fixed by each Contracting Party concerned |
| 6.5 | Surcharge for the use of the period of grace (Article 7(4) of the Protocol) | 50% of the amount of the fee payable under item 6.1. |

7. *Miscellaneous recordings (Article 9ter of the Protocol)*

- | | | |
|-----|---|-----|
| 7.1 | Total transfer of an international registration | 177 |
| 7.2 | Partial transfer (for some of the goods and services or for some of the Contracting Parties) of an international registration | 177 |
| 7.3 | Limitation requested by the holder subsequent to international registration, provided that, if the limitation affects more than one Contracting Party, it is the same for all | 177 |

*Schedule of Fees**Swiss francs*

7.4	Change in the name and/or address of the holder and/or, where the holder is a legal entity, introduction of or change in the indications concerning the legal nature of the holder and the State and, where applicable, the territorial unit within that State under the law of which the said legal entity has been organized for one or more international registrations for which the same recording or change is requested in the same form	150
7.5	Recording of a license in respect of an international registration or amendment of the recording of a license	177
7.6	Request for a continued processing under Rule 5 <i>bis</i> (1)	200
7.7	Division of an international registration	177

8. Information concerning international registrations (Article 5*ter* of the Protocol)

8.1	Establishing a certified extract from the International Register consisting of an analysis of the situation of an international registration (detailed certified extract),	
–	up to three pages	155
–	for each page after the third	10

*Schedule of Fees**Swiss francs*

8.2	Establishing a certified extract from the International Register consisting of a copy of all publications, and of all notifications of refusal, made with respect to an international registration (simple certified extract),	
–	up to three pages	77
–	for each page after the third	2
8.3	A single attestation or information in writing	
–	for a single international registration	77
–	for each additional international registration if the same information is requested in the same request	10
8.4	Reprint or photocopy of the publication of an international registration, per page	5

9. *Special services*

The International Bureau is authorized to collect a fee, whose amount it shall itself fix, for operations to be performed urgently and for services not covered by this Schedule of Fees.

10. *Continuation of Effects*

10.1	Fee for the International Bureau	23
10.2	Fee to be transferred by the International Bureau to the successor State	41

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